ENGLISH FOR WORK / SCOPE / SCHEDULES / DECISIONS / DELIVERY

Project Management English

Make the dependency visible. Make the decision clear.



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Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

Your route through the book

01 Project Charter and Scope Definition, page 4

Clarify the users, decisions, boundaries, and acceptance basis behind a sponsor request before treating a target date as a commitment.

02 Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies, page 14

Explain a schedule impact using dependencies, working days, and remaining durations while keeping recovery options conditional.

03 Risk Register and Issue Escalation, page 27

Escalate a confirmed delivery problem while separating the known event, uncertain consequences, and unapproved response.

04 Stakeholder Alignment and Governance, page 37

Close a governance meeting with a clear decision status, accountable authority, and accurate record of recommendations and actions.

05 Change Requests and Scope Creep, page 49

Respond constructively to a late scope request by comparing explicit options, effort, schedule effects, and approval status.

06 Status Reporting and Executive Updates, page 59

Produce a concise executive update that shows material threats, rating criteria, and decision needs without confusing task counts with delivery confidence.

07 Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery, page 73

Resolve a delivery-status disagreement by linking agreed criteria to evidence, distinguishing missing proof from failure, and naming the acceptance authority.

08 Post-Implementation Review, page 83

Convert a vague lesson into a specific process change with an owner, deadline, adoption check, and separate effectiveness review.

Professional communication notes, page 3

Three additional workplace cases, page 97

Answers and explanations, page 111

Phrase finder, page 169

Vocabulary index, page 171

References and publication notes, page 176

Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

A useful update enables a decision.

Project conversations compress complicated situations into short phrases: nearly done, approved in principle, on track, or just one more feature. Each can hide a different uncertainty. These cases develop the language for unpacking the claim, identifying the consequence, and making the next decision explicit without burying the listener in a task-by-task history.

Give each claim a reference point

A delay needs a baseline and a calendar. Completion needs acceptance evidence. A color rating needs defined criteria. State the basis before expecting another person to act on the label.
"Testing is forecast three working days behind the approved schedule."

Separate an option from authorization

A useful proposal can still be unapproved. Say who recommends it, who can decide, what changes, and when a decision is needed. Do not turn meeting enthusiasm into permission.
"The group recommends deferring the feature; approval is still required."

Distinguish present problems from uncertainty

A confirmed missed commitment is an issue to manage now. Its full consequences may remain uncertain. Keep both the present fact and the future exposure visible.
"The supplier has confirmed the miss; the replacement delivery date is still unknown."

Close the communication loop

Name the action, owner, deadline, and evidence needed to close it. A sent message, a scheduled review, or a vendor completion claim is not proof that the receiving team accepted the result.
"Two acceptance criteria still lack evidence; please confirm their review owner."

Professional boundaries

Original fictional language practice, not a project-management certification, contract interpretation, engineering instruction, or release authorization. All organizations, dates, numbers, and decisions are invented. Actual work must follow the governing agreement, approved project controls, applicable rules, and responsible decision makers.

A Read the situation

LESSON 01 / PROJECT CHARTER AND SCOPE DEFINITION

Clarify the users, decisions, boundaries, and acceptance basis behind a sponsor request before treating a target date as a commitment.

A dashboard is not yet a defined project

Sponsor Greg requests a dashboard in four weeks, but the initial brief does not identify users, decisions, or exclusions. In a planning meeting with project manager Elena, he proposes a first release for operations leads doing weekly queue triage: overdue-item visibility and an export. Automated work allocation would be excluded. Data access and acceptance criteria remain unconfirmed, and no scope baseline is approved. Elena must turn the request into a reviewable definition without promising the four-week target.

People: Greg, Project sponsor; Elena, Project manager.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Who are the proposed first-release users?

A. Only the finance audit committee
B. Unspecified public visitors
C. Operations leads doing weekly queue triage
D. Every external customer

2. Which feature is proposed as excluded?

A. Automated work allocation
B. Overdue-item visibility
C. An export
D. Access to the proposed first-release view

3. What does four weeks represent now?

A. An approved baseline with all dependencies confirmed
B. A requested target, not a supported delivery commitment
C. A completed acceptance decision
D. Proof that data access is available

Answers and explanations, page 111

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

project charter
A document formally establishing a project and its high-level authority and purpose.

approve the project charter

project sponsor
The person accountable for sponsorship and relevant business decisions.

confirm the project sponsor

business need
The problem or opportunity the work is intended to address.

clarify the business need

business case
The justification for the proposed investment and expected value.

review the business case

project objective
A specific result the project is intended to achieve.

define the project objective

deliverable
A defined output to be produced by the project.

identify the deliverable

outcome
A change or result enabled by using the project's outputs.

distinguish outputs from outcomes

benefit
A measurable improvement of value from the change.

define the expected benefit

scope statement
A description of the work and boundaries included in the project.

refine the scope statement

scope baseline
The approved scope reference used to manage and assess changes.

establish the scope baseline

in scope
Included within the defined project boundary.

confirm what is in scope

out of scope
Excluded from the defined project boundary.

state what is out of scope

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

project charter PROJECT CHARTER

approve the project charter

Keep the meaning precise: A document formally establishing a project and its high-level authority and purpose.

deliverable DELIVERABLE

identify the deliverable

Keep the meaning precise: A defined output to be produced by the project.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

assumption

A premise used for planning that needs appropriate validation or monitoring.

record a planning assumption

constraint

A limit within which the project must operate.

identify a constraint

requirement

A defined need or condition the solution must satisfy.

clarify the requirement

acceptance criterion

A condition used to decide whether an output is acceptable.

define acceptance criteria

stakeholder

A person or group affected by or able to affect the project.

identify key stakeholders

end user

A person who will use the delivered capability.

consult the end user

decision use

The decision or action a delivered information product supports.

clarify the decision use

work breakdown structure

A hierarchical division of project work into manageable components, abbreviated WBS.

develop the work breakdown structure

work package

A defined unit of work that can be assigned and managed.

specify a work package

requirements traceability

Links connecting needs, requirements, work, and evidence.

maintain requirements traceability

success measure

A defined indicator used to assess the intended result.

agree a success measure

scope approval

Authorization of the stated project boundaries and work.

obtain scope approval

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

out of scope OUT OF SCOPE

state what is out of scope

Keep the meaning precise: Excluded from the defined project boundary.

stakeholder STAKEHOLDER

identify key stakeholders

Keep the meaning precise: A person or group affected by or able to affect the project.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Clarify the need

Which decision should the dashboard help users make?

Name the audience

The proposed first users are operations leads.

Anchor the task

They will use it for weekly queue triage.

Define the output

The first release would show overdue items and provide an export.

State the exclusion

Automated allocation is outside the proposed first release.

Separate value from output

A delivered screen is not itself evidence of better queue decisions.

Qualify the date

Four weeks is the requested target, not yet a delivery commitment.

Identify a dependency

We still need to confirm access to the source data.

Ask for acceptance

What evidence will show that the first release meets the agreed need?

Name the approver

Who is authorized to accept the defined output?

Keep assumptions visible

Record the data-access assumption until it is verified.

Avoid implied additions

A useful future feature is not automatically part of this release.

Define a measurable check

Replace looks good with a checkable acceptance condition.

Preserve the proposal

These are proposed boundaries pending review.

Connect the records

Link the requirements to the scope and acceptance evidence.

Close the definition

Confirm users, decision use, inclusions, exclusions, and approval route.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Define the output
Useful wording: The first release would show overdue items and provide an export.

Purpose: State the exclusion
Useful wording: Automated allocation is outside the proposed first release.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which scope statement best matches the supplied proposal?

A. A complete automated allocation platform for all customers

B. Any feature suggested during development

C. A screen with no identified user or decision

D. Overdue-item visibility and export for weekly operations triage, excluding automated allocation

2. What can Elena responsibly say about four weeks?

A. It is guaranteed because the sponsor requested it.

B. It is already an achieved delivery date.

C. It means every proposed future feature is included.

D. It is the target; access, acceptance, and feasibility still need confirmation.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The justification for the proposed investment and expected value. Which term fits?

A. business case

B. requirement

C. work package

D. scope statement

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A dashboard is not yet a defined project". Greg: "I do not need automated work allocation in the first version. That might become useful later, but visibility and an export are the immediate request." Elena: [missing response] Greg: "I want the leads to make better queue decisions, not just get another screen. How do we keep that outcome distinct from what the team is building?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Record that assumption and its owner. We should establish the access conditions before treating the source as ready for development and testing.

B. I will make that out of scope for the proposed first release. A possible future capability should not quietly enter the current delivery commitment.

C. We need an acceptance criterion for each relevant requirement. We also need to identify who can accept the output and what evidence they will review.

D. That belongs in the scope statement. Once the appropriate review and authorization occur, we can distinguish the approved reference from later requests to add features.

Answers and explanations, page 111

One useful distinction

A dashboard is an output; improved queue decisions would be an intended outcome. The proposed users and exclusions narrow the request, but they do not confirm access, acceptance, or schedule feasibility. Four weeks remains a target until supported and authorized.

E Conversation

A dashboard is not yet a defined project

A dashboard is not yet a defined project

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

business need / acceptance criterion / scope approval / assumption / requirements traceability / end user / constraint / deliverable / out of scope / scope statement

01 **Greg:** I would like the dashboard in four weeks. The request is short because I thought the team would know what a useful operations dashboard should contain.

02 **Elena:** We need to clarify the [1] _____. Which decision should it support, and who will use it? Those answers help us define the first release rather than guess.

03 **Greg:** Operations leads would use it for weekly queue triage. They need to see overdue items and take an export into the planning discussion.

04 **Elena:** That gives us a specific [2] _____ and task. It is more actionable than a dashboard for everyone, because we can connect the requirements to a real workflow.

05 **Greg:** I do not need automated work allocation in the first version. That might become useful later, but visibility and an export are the immediate request.

06 **Elena:** I will make that [3] _____ for the proposed first release. A possible future capability should not quietly enter the current delivery commitment.

07 **Greg:** I want the leads to make better queue decisions, not just get another screen. How do we keep that outcome distinct from what the team is building?

08 **Elena:** Distinguish the [4] _____ from the intended outcome. We can deliver a working view, but better queue decisions require the right information and actual use by the leads.

09 **Greg:** We should probably define what shows that the view is adequate. Otherwise I might approve a demonstration and discover later that it cannot support the weekly meeting.

10 **Elena:** We need an [5] _____ for each relevant requirement. We also need to identify who can accept the output and what evidence they will review.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A dashboard is not yet a defined project

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Greg:** I need to check my assumption about the data. The records exist, but the data team has not confirmed that this project can access them.

12 **Elena:** Record that [6] _____ and its owner. We should establish the access conditions before treating the source as ready for development and testing.

13 **Greg:** Then four weeks may still be possible, but I should not tell other departments it is an approved delivery promise simply because I prefer that date.

14 **Elena:** Correct. The [7] _____ needs assessment alongside the work and dependencies. If the date is fixed, we need a supported scope and delivery plan within that limit.

15 **Greg:** I am comfortable reviewing a clearer definition first. It should show the user, the two requested capabilities, the exclusion, and the open access question.

16 **Elena:** That belongs in the [8] _____. Once the appropriate review and authorization occur, we can distinguish the approved reference from later requests to add features.

17 **Greg:** We should keep the requirements connected to the reason for the project. Otherwise an attractive feature may distract us from the weekly triage need.

18 **Elena:** Use [9] _____ to preserve those connections. The record should show why the work exists, how it is checked, and whether it belongs in this release.

19 **Greg:** Good. Please bring the definition and unresolved decisions to the review. I will not announce the date or the wider automation feature as approved today.

20 **Elena:** Then we can seek [10] _____ on a clear basis. The immediate result is a reviewable proposal, not a promise built from a product name and a target alone.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. business need / **2.** end user / **3.** out of scope / **4.** deliverable / **5.** acceptance criterion / **6.** assumption / **7.** constraint / **8.** scope statement / **9.** requirements traceability / **10.** scope approval

Why these answers fit, page 112

F Check accuracy and scope

A dashboard is not yet a defined project

Return to the case

Sponsor Greg requests a dashboard in four weeks, but the initial brief does not identify users, decisions, or exclusions. In a planning meeting with project manager Elena, he proposes a first release for operations leads doing weekly queue triage: overdue-item visibility and an export. Automated work allocation would be excluded. Data access and acceptance criteria remain unconfirmed, and no scope baseline is approved. Elena must turn the request into a reviewable definition without promising the four-week target.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which is an outcome rather than merely an output?

A. An export button exists.
B. A project charter is stored.
C. Operations leads make better-supported queue-priority decisions.
D. A dashboard file is delivered.

2. A sponsor likes the demonstration but the acceptance criteria and authority remain unconfirmed. Which status is justified?

A. Four-week delivery guaranteed because the sponsor likes the concept.
B. Favorable feedback received; formal acceptance is not established.
C. Scope approved because the demonstration was well received.
D. Acceptance complete because the output exists.

Answers and explanations, page 114

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20. Keep the four-week target and data-access assumption separate from approval.

Clarification protects the intended value

A sponsor may name a solution before describing the decision it should support. Ask what people will do with the result and what belongs outside the first release. The questions make the request actionable; they do not require the sponsor to design every technical detail.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

An export is not automation

A proposed first release includes a weekly export for operations leads. Automated allocation is excluded. Data access is unconfirmed, and the target date has not been approved.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

unconfirmed / export / excluded / commitment

01 **Sponsor:** The included capability is a weekly [1] _____.

02 **Manager:** Automated allocation is [2] _____.

03 **Sponsor:** Data access remains [3] _____.

04 **Manager:** The target is not an approved [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. export / **2.** excluded / **3.** unconfirmed / **4.** commitment

Why these answers fit, page 114

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A dashboard is not yet a defined project". Greg: "Then four weeks may still be possible, but I should not tell other departments it is an approved delivery promise simply because I prefer that date." Elena: [missing response] Greg: "I am comfortable reviewing a clearer definition first. It should show the user, the two requested capabilities, the exclusion, and the open access question." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Use requirements traceability to preserve those connections. The record should show why the work exists, how it is checked, and whether it belongs in this release.

B. Distinguish the deliverable from the intended outcome. We can deliver a working view, but better queue decisions require the right information and actual use by the leads.

C. Correct. The constraint needs assessment alongside the work and dependencies. If the date is fixed, we need a supported scope and delivery plan within that limit.

D. We need an acceptance criterion for each relevant requirement. We also need to identify who can accept the output and what evidence they will review.

Answers and explanations, page 115

A Read the situation

LESSON 02 / SCHEDULE, CRITICAL PATH, AND DEPENDENCIES

Explain a schedule impact using dependencies, working days, and remaining durations while keeping recovery options conditional.

One late task can move the release

Planner Luis and delivery lead Anika examine a simplified working-day schedule. Testing was due at the end of day 5 and is now forecast to finish at the end of day 8. Rehearsal takes two working days after testing, followed by a one-day approval task. These finish-to-start links have no lag or buffer, and this chain controls the release milestone. Other work is on schedule. No recovery change is approved; durations and the working calendar are unchanged.

People: Luis, Project planner; Anika, Delivery lead.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. How late is the testing finish forecast?

A. Two calendar months
B. No delay
C. Three working days
D. Eight working days

2. When did the baseline release chain finish?

A. End of day 8
B. End of day 5
C. End of day 10
D. End of day 11

3. What is the forecast release finish with unchanged logic and durations?

A. End of day 11
B. End of day 8
C. End of day 9
D. End of day 13

Answers and explanations, page 116

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

schedule baseline
The approved timing reference used to assess project progress.

compare with the schedule baseline

schedule forecast
The current estimate of future task or milestone timing.

update the schedule forecast

working calendar
The defined days and hours available for scheduled work.

apply the working calendar

working day
A day counted as available work under the stated calendar.

state the delay in working days

activity duration
The time needed to perform a defined scheduled task.

estimate activity duration

remaining duration
The work time still needed to finish an activity.

update remaining duration

predecessor
A task whose timing affects a linked later task.

identify the predecessor

successor
A task whose timing depends on a linked earlier task.

assess the successor

finish-to-start dependency
A link requiring the predecessor to finish before the successor starts.

check a finish-to-start dependency

lag
A specified waiting interval in a dependency link.

define the lag

lead
An allowed overlap relative to a dependency link.

justify a schedule lead

critical path
The controlling task sequence determining the schedule's earliest completion.

analyze the critical path

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

schedule baseline SCHEDULE BASELINE

compare with the schedule baseline

Keep the meaning precise: The approved timing reference used to assess project progress.

remaining duration REMAINING DURATION

update remaining duration

Keep the meaning precise: The work time still needed to finish an activity.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

total float

Time an activity can move without delaying the defined project finish under the schedule model.

assess total float

free float

Time an activity can move without delaying the earliest start of its successor.

distinguish free float

milestone

A defined project event used to track an important point.

confirm the release milestone

slippage

Movement later than the stated planned timing.

report schedule slippage

downstream impact

The effect of a change on subsequent linked work.

trace the downstream impact

resequence

Change the order or logic of planned tasks.

assess whether to resequence work

fast-tracking

Overlapping work that was planned in sequence, with resulting risks.

assess fast-tracking

crashing

Shortening duration by adding resources or cost where feasible.

evaluate schedule crashing

resource leveling

Adjusting timing to resolve resource limits or conflicts.

apply resource leveling

schedule compression

Reducing planned duration through an assessed change.

assess schedule compression

recovery option

A proposed way to regain lost time or restore a milestone.

evaluate a recovery option

forecast variance

The difference between current forecast and the specified baseline.

explain the forecast variance

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

critical path CRITICAL PATH

analyze the critical path

Keep the meaning precise: The controlling task sequence determining the schedule's earliest completion.

downstream impact DOWNSTREAM IMPACT

trace the downstream impact

Keep the meaning precise: The effect of a change on subsequent linked work.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Start with the movement

Testing is forecast to finish three working days late.

Name the blocked step

Rehearsal cannot start until testing finishes.

Calculate the baseline

The original chain completed at the end of day 8.

Qualify the arithmetic

This chain has no buffer and controls the release milestone.

Keep calendars consistent

These are working days under the same calendar.

Explore resources carefully

Additional people shorten the task only if the work can use them effectively.

Keep recovery conditional

No schedule-recovery change has been approved.

Ask for a decision

Compare the feasible recovery options and their consequences.

State the comparison

The baseline finish is day 5; the current forecast is day 8.

Explain the sequence

Two days of rehearsal are followed by one day of approval.

Calculate the forecast

With unchanged logic, the chain now completes at the end of day 11.

Avoid false averaging

On-time work elsewhere does not cancel this controlling delay.

Avoid double counting

The three-day delay moves the chain; it is not added separately at every task.

Distinguish overlap

Fast-tracking changes sequencing and may create rework risk.

Preserve the reference

Update the forecast without silently rewriting the baseline.

Close the update

Report the milestone impact, assumptions, owner, and next checkpoint.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Explain the sequence
Useful wording: Two days of rehearsal are followed by one day of approval.

Purpose: Calculate the baseline
Useful wording: The original chain completed at the end of day 8.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which statement correctly reports the unchanged forecast?

A. Every downstream task adds another three-day delay, making nine.

B. Other on-time tasks cancel the delay automatically.

C. Testing finishes on day 8, so release must happen that same day.

D. Release moves from end of day 8 to end of day 11, a three-working-day delay.

2. Another path has four days of float. Does that automatically absorb this chain's three-day slip?

A. No; float on another path does not change this controlling chain's zero-buffer logic.

B. Yes; four days minus three leaves one day available for any task.

C. Yes; all float is a project-wide pool that can be transferred without changing the schedule.

D. No; it makes the release slip seven days because the float must be added.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A day counted as available work under the stated calendar. Which term fits?

A. working day

B. milestone

C. finish-to-start dependency

D. resource leveling

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "One late task can move the release". Anika: "If testing now finishes at the end of day eight, could rehearsal still start that morning? Both dates would say day eight on the chart." Luis: [missing response] Anika: "I nearly added three days for testing and another three for each successor. That would have made the delay nine days, which looks wrong." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. The schedule baseline shows rehearsal on days six and seven and approval on day eight. Those durations and links have not changed.

B. Not under this critical path. Testing must finish before rehearsal, and rehearsal before approval. That chain controls release, with no buffer in the simplified model.

C. That would be a crashing option if resources can actually shorten duration. Check the remaining work, constraints, cost, and coordination before promising recovery.

D. No. The finish-to-start dependency requires completed testing. With no overlap or lag, rehearsal uses days nine and ten; approval follows on day eleven.

Answers and explanations, page 116

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Baseline: testing through day 5, rehearsal days 6-7, approval day 8. Forecast: testing through day 8, rehearsal days 9-10, approval day 11. The milestone moves three working days, not three days for each downstream task.

E Conversation

One late task can move the release

One late task can move the release

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

crashing / critical path / finish-to-start dependency / total float / working calendar / downstream impact / fast-tracking / schedule forecast / schedule baseline / forecast variance

01 **Anika:** Most of the project is on schedule, but testing has moved from day five to day eight. Can I leave the release milestone unchanged in the sponsor report?

02 **Luis:** Not under this [1] _____. Testing must finish before rehearsal, and rehearsal before approval. That chain controls release, with no buffer in the simplified model.

03 **Anika:** Let me reconstruct the original sequence first. Testing through day five, then two days of rehearsal, then one day for approval. Was release originally day eight?

04 **Luis:** Yes. The [2] _____ shows rehearsal on days six and seven and approval on day eight. Those durations and links have not changed.

05 **Anika:** If testing now finishes at the end of day eight, could rehearsal still start that morning? Both dates would say day eight on the chart.

06 **Luis:** No. The [3] _____ requires completed testing. With no overlap or lag, rehearsal uses days nine and ten; approval follows on day eleven.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Anika:** I nearly added three days for testing and another three for each successor. That would have made the delay nine days, which looks wrong.

08 **Luis:** The [4] _____ is three working days overall. Each linked activity shifts by three; we do not add the same shift repeatedly to the final milestone.

09 **Anika:** I will show end of day eleven against end of day eight. These are working-day numbers, not three ordinary dates on a calendar.

10 **Luis:** Correct. Keep the [5] _____ consistent. A weekend or holiday must be handled through the dated schedule, not silently counted differently between the two versions.

Conversation continues on the next page.

One late task can move the release

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Anika:** Another team says its tasks have four days available. Could I transfer those four days to testing and cancel our three-day delay?

12 **Luis:** No. Their [6] _____ belongs to that schedule path. Spare time elsewhere does not change this chain's dependencies or create a buffer where none exists.

13 **Anika:** Could adding testers shorten the remaining work? I can ask for an assessment, but some test steps may depend on the same environment.

14 **Luis:** That would be a [7] _____ option if resources can actually shorten duration. Check the remaining work, constraints, cost, and coordination before promising recovery.

15 **Anika:** The other proposal starts some rehearsal before testing finishes. That sounds different from adding people and could require rehearsal to be repeated.

16 **Luis:** It is [8] _____, because it overlaps previously sequential work. We need to assess what can overlap, whether the input is usable, and the resulting risk.

17 **Anika:** Neither proposal has been assessed and approved. For now I will keep day eleven as the current estimate, with the original day eight still visible.

18 **Luis:** Update the [9] _____ that way. Do not replace the approved reference merely to make the report show no difference.

19 **Anika:** My sponsor update will explain the blocked rehearsal, three-day milestone movement, unchanged assumptions, and recovery options still under review. It will not announce recovered time.

20 **Luis:** That preserves the [10] _____. I will verify the dated calendar and option assumptions for the next review; until then, day eleven remains our supported forecast.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. critical path / **2.** schedule baseline / **3.** finish-to-start dependency / **4.** downstream impact / **5.** working calendar / **6.** total float / **7.** crashing / **8.** fast-tracking / **9.** schedule forecast / **10.** forecast variance

Why these answers fit, page 117

F Check accuracy and scope

One late task can move the release

Return to the case

Planner Luis and delivery lead Anika examine a simplified working-day schedule. Testing was due at the end of day 5 and is now forecast to finish at the end of day 8. Rehearsal takes two working days after testing, followed by a one-day approval task. These finish-to-start links have no lag or buffer, and this chain controls the release milestone. Other work is on schedule. No recovery change is approved; durations and the working calendar are unchanged.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which proposal is fast-tracking?

A. Add any number of people without examining the task

B. Rename the baseline date without a decision

C. Treat calendar weekends as working days without a calendar change

D. Overlap tasks previously planned in sequence, after assessing feasibility and risk

2. A different task has four days of total float and slips three days with no other changes. What follows?

A. Its slip can be absorbed without moving the defined project finish.

B. Every project always slips three days.

C. The task has gained seven days of float.

D. Float means the task can be omitted.

Answers and explanations, page 119

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20. Contrast float on another path, added-resource crashing, and overlapping-work fast-tracking.

Explain the chain, not only the late task

A listener may hear that most work is on time and assume the release is safe. Show how the delayed predecessor moves the next necessary step. State the assumptions clearly so a forecast is neither understated nor presented as an unavoidable result if a feasible recovery option later receives approval.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Carry the delay once

In a simplified working-day chain, testing was due day 4 and is now forecast day 6. A one-day review must follow, with no buffer or lag. No recovery is approved.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

five / two / approved / seven

01 **Planner:** The original chain finished on day [1] _____.

02 **Lead:** The forecast finish is now day [2] _____.

03 **Planner:** That is a [3] _____-working-day delay.

04 **Lead:** No recovery has been [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. five / **2.** seven / **3.** two / **4.** approved

Why these answers fit, page 119

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "One late task can move the release". Anika: "Could adding testers shorten the remaining work? I can ask for an assessment, but some test steps may depend on the same environment." Luis: [missing response] Anika: "The other proposal starts some rehearsal before testing finishes. That sounds different from adding people and could require rehearsal to be repeated." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. The schedule baseline shows rehearsal on days six and seven and approval on day eight. Those durations and links have not changed.

B. Not under this critical path. Testing must finish before rehearsal, and rehearsal before approval. That chain controls release, with no buffer in the simplified model.

C. No. The finish-to-start dependency requires completed testing. With no overlap or lag, rehearsal uses days nine and ten; approval follows on day eleven.

D. That would be a crashing option if resources can actually shorten duration. Check the remaining work, constraints, cost, and coordination before promising recovery.

Answers and explanations, page 120

Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Project Charter and Scope Definition" and "Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The problem or opportunity the work is intended to address. Which term fits?

A. work breakdown structure

B. business need

C. constraint

D. benefit

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A task whose timing depends on a linked earlier task. Which term fits?

A. schedule baseline

B. total float

C. successor

D. fast-tracking

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A dashboard is not yet a defined project". Greg: "We should probably define what shows that the view is adequate. Otherwise I might approve a demonstration and discover later that it cannot support the weekly meeting." Elena: [missing response] Greg: "I need to check my assumption about the data. The records exist, but the data team has not confirmed that this project can access them." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That belongs in the scope statement. Once the appropriate review and authorization occur, we can distinguish the approved reference from later requests to add features.

B. Correct. The constraint needs assessment alongside the work and dependencies. If the date is fixed, we need a supported scope and delivery plan within that limit.

C. I will make that out of scope for the proposed first release. A possible future capability should not quietly enter the current delivery commitment.

D. We need an acceptance criterion for each relevant requirement. We also need to identify who can accept the output and what evidence they will review.

Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "One late task can move the release". Anika: "Neither proposal has been assessed and approved. For now I will keep day eleven as the current estimate, with the original day eight still visible." Luis: [missing response] Anika: "My sponsor update will explain the blocked rehearsal, three-day milestone movement, unchanged assumptions, and recovery options still under review. It will not announce recovered time." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No. The finish-to-start dependency requires completed testing. With no overlap or lag, rehearsal uses days nine and ten; approval follows on day eleven.

B. Update the schedule forecast that way. Do not replace the approved reference merely to make the report show no difference.

C. That would be a crashing option if resources can actually shorten duration. Check the remaining work, constraints, cost, and coordination before promising recovery.

D. Yes. The schedule baseline shows rehearsal on days six and seven and approval on day eight. Those durations and links have not changed.

Answers and explanations, page 151

A Read the situation

LESSON 03 / RISK REGISTER AND ISSUE ESCALATION

Escalate a confirmed delivery problem while separating the known event, uncertain consequences, and unapproved response.

> **The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility**
>
> Project manager Rina and procurement lead Omar review a supplier commitment for October 12. The supplier has confirmed that date will be missed and gives October 15 only as an earliest possible date, not a new commitment. Testing planned for October 13 needs the delivery. The risk register still describes a possible delay with a 30% likelihood. No replacement source or recovery plan is approved. Rina must update the status, preserve the history, and request a useful escalation.

People: Rina, Project manager; Omar, Procurement lead.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What has the supplier confirmed?

A. The October 12 commitment will be missed.
B. Delivery is guaranteed on October 15.
C. Testing has already finished.
D. A replacement source is approved.

2. What does October 15 represent?

A. The actual receipt date
B. The approved release date
C. The date all risk disappears
D. The earliest possible date mentioned, not a commitment

3. Why is the October 13 test exposed?

A. It is unrelated to the supplier item.
B. It has already passed without the item.
C. Every testing task always lasts thirty days.
D. It requires the delivery that will miss October 12.

Answers and explanations, page 121

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

risk
Uncertainty that may affect a project objective positively or negatively.

assess project risk

threat
A potential event or condition with an adverse effect.

identify a delivery threat

opportunity
Uncertainty with a potentially beneficial effect on an objective.

assess an opportunity

risk register
A record of identified risks, assessment, ownership, and responses.

maintain the risk register

issue
A current event, question, or concern requiring management action; in this case, a confirmed delivery problem.

log an issue

issue log
A record tracking current problems and their resolution.

update the issue log

risk owner
The person accountable for managing a defined risk.

assign a risk owner

action owner
The person responsible for carrying out a particular response action.

name the action owner

likelihood
The assessed chance of an uncertain event or condition.

reassess likelihood

impact
The consequence for a defined objective if an event occurs.

assess schedule impact

risk exposure
The project's susceptibility to the relevant uncertainty and consequences.

review risk exposure

trigger
A condition or event prompting a defined response.

recognize the trigger

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

risk RISK

assess project risk

Keep the meaning precise: Uncertainty that may affect a project objective positively or negatively.

issue log ISSUE LOG

update the issue log

Keep the meaning precise: A record tracking current problems and their resolution.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

risk response

A planned or implemented action addressing an identified risk.

develop a risk response

mitigation

Action intended to reduce a threat's likelihood or impact.

assess mitigation

contingency plan

A prepared response to be used if specified conditions arise.

activate a contingency plan

fallback plan

An alternative response if the primary response does not work.

prepare a fallback plan

residual risk

Risk remaining after a response has been applied.

monitor residual risk

secondary risk

New risk introduced by a response to another risk.

identify secondary risks

escalation threshold

The point at which an issue or risk must be referred to higher authority.

apply the escalation threshold

escalation brief

A concise statement of the problem, consequence, and help or decision needed.

prepare an escalation brief

decision deadline

The latest time a decision is needed to support the stated plan.

state the decision deadline

contingency reserve

Provision for identified uncertainty within the applicable plan.

clarify contingency-reserve use

response status

Whether a response is proposed, approved, underway, or completed.

report response status

closure evidence

Information showing that the stated closure conditions are met.

require closure evidence

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

trigger TRIGGER

recognize the trigger

Keep the meaning precise: A condition or event prompting a defined response.

residual risk RESIDUAL RISK

monitor residual risk

Keep the meaning precise: Risk remaining after a response has been applied.

C Phrases that move the work forward

State the confirmed event

The supplier has confirmed it will miss October 12.

Correct the old wording

Possible delay no longer describes the commitment status.

Preserve uncertainty

The replacement delivery date is not committed.

Qualify the earliest date

October 15 is the earliest possibility mentioned.

Connect the dependency

The October 13 test requires this delivery.

Keep the history

Link the issue to the original risk entry.

Separate consequences

The delivery miss is confirmed; the full milestone impact is still being assessed.

Name the owner

Assign responsibility for obtaining a committed supplier recovery plan.

Make the request actionable

We need a decision on the feasible response options.

Avoid imaginary recovery

No alternative source has been approved.

Distinguish planning from action

A contingency plan must be checked before it is treated as activated.

Watch new exposure

Expediting can introduce cost or quality risks.

Retain residual risk

A response may reduce exposure without removing every uncertainty.

Set the decision time

State when the decision is needed and why.

Define closure

Close only when the agreed evidence supports closure.

Close the escalation

Report the fact, consequence, owner, response status, and next checkpoint.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Qualify the earliest date
Useful wording: October 15 is the earliest possibility mentioned.

Purpose: Connect the dependency
Useful wording: The October 13 test requires this delivery.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which opening is accurate now?

A. There is only a 30% chance the original commitment will be missed.

B. October 15 is a guaranteed recovery.

C. The issue is closed because the supplier replied.

D. The October 12 miss is confirmed; the replacement date remains uncommitted.

2. How should the original risk record be handled?

A. Mark all project risks closed.

B. Update its status and link it to the current issue while preserving history.

C. Delete every reference so no one sees the earlier warning.

D. Keep the old wording unchanged because impact is uncertain.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A record of identified risks, assessment, ownership, and responses. Which term fits?

A. likelihood

B. contingency plan

C. decision deadline

D. risk register

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility". Rina: "Testing is planned for October thirteenth and requires the delivery. That is the immediate dependency we need to show in the escalation." Omar: [missing response] Rina: "Should we remove the original risk entry now? I do not want two records to make it look like two separate supplier problems." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. A contingency plan must be usable under the current facts. A named alternative is not automatically available, qualified, authorized, or fast enough for the test.

B. Those are potential secondary risks. Assess them alongside the remaining exposure from the original delay, and keep the response options comparable on a stated basis.

C. State the impact carefully. The planned test is threatened by the confirmed miss, but we still need a supported assessment of the full milestone consequence.

D. That is a useful escalation brief. It gives the decision maker something to act on rather than a long register entry with no clear request.

Answers and explanations, page 121

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The missed commitment is a present issue once confirmed; the replacement date and final effect may still be uncertain. Update the issue and linked risk records without erasing the history or pretending every downstream consequence is already known.

E Conversation

The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility

The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

issue / action owner / closure evidence / risk register / response status / escalation brief / secondary risks / trigger / contingency plan / impact

01 **Rina:** The supplier has confirmed it will miss October twelfth, but our register still says possible delivery delay with a thirty-percent likelihood. That wording is now misleading.

02 **Omar:** We have a current [1] _____. The uncertainty is no longer whether the original commitment will be met; it concerns the replacement timing and the consequences for our work.

03 **Rina:** The supplier mentioned October fifteenth as the earliest possible date. I want to make sure nobody turns that into a confirmed recovery in the project update.

04 **Omar:** Keep the [2] _____ explicit. The supplier has not committed to the fifteenth, and we have no approved replacement source or recovery plan.

05 **Rina:** Testing is planned for October thirteenth and requires the delivery. That is the immediate dependency we need to show in the escalation.

06 **Omar:** State the [3] _____ carefully. The planned test is threatened by the confirmed miss, but we still need a supported assessment of the full milestone consequence.

07 **Rina:** Should we remove the original risk entry now? I do not want two records to make it look like two separate supplier problems.

08 **Omar:** Update the [4] _____ and link it to the issue log. Preserve the history and distinguish the event status rather than deleting the warning or duplicating its impact.

09 **Rina:** Our escalation condition was a missed supplier commitment. That has happened, so we should act now rather than wait for a better replacement date.

10 **Omar:** The [5] _____ has occurred. An uncertain recovery date is not a reason to postpone acknowledging the event that activates the response.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Rina:** I need someone clearly responsible for obtaining the supplier's committed plan. A general instruction to procurement will not tell the sponsor who is following up.

12 **Omar:** Name an [6] _____ for that task, with a due time and escalation route. That is separate from pretending the person can guarantee a date the supplier has not committed to.

13 **Rina:** There may be a contingency in the procurement plan, but we should check its conditions and availability before saying it has solved the problem.

14 **Omar:** Exactly. A [7] _____ must be usable under the current facts. A named alternative is not automatically available, qualified, authorized, or fast enough for the test.

15 **Rina:** If we expedite or switch sources, we may create new costs or quality questions. The escalation should not present every response as an uncomplicated improvement.

16 **Omar:** Those are potential [8] _____. Assess them alongside the remaining exposure from the original delay, and keep the response options comparable on a stated basis.

17 **Rina:** I will prepare a short decision request: confirmed miss, affected test, uncommitted replacement date, options under assessment, and the time when support is needed.

18 **Omar:** That is a useful [9] _____. It gives the decision maker something to act on rather than a long register entry with no clear request.

19 **Rina:** What evidence will change the status? I do not want the next reassuring email to close the issue while testing still lacks its required delivery.

20 **Omar:** Require [10] _____. A committed plan may change the status, but completion and closure depend on the agreed conditions and verified result, not the tone of the reply.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. issue / **2.** response status / **3.** impact / **4.** risk register / **5.** trigger / **6.** action owner / **7.** contingency plan / **8.** secondary risks / **9.** escalation brief / **10.** closure evidence

Why these answers fit, page 122

F Check accuracy and scope

The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility

Return to the case

Project manager Rina and procurement lead Omar review a supplier commitment for October 12. The supplier has confirmed that date will be missed and gives October 15 only as an earliest possible date, not a new commitment. Testing planned for October 13 needs the delivery. The risk register still describes a possible delay with a 30% likelihood. No replacement source or recovery plan is approved. Rina must update the status, preserve the history, and request a useful escalation.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What should an escalation request include?

A. A completed approval that never occurred
B. An unsupported guarantee that testing is unaffected
C. The confirmed problem, affected objective, options, decision owner, and needed timing
D. Only the sentence supplier bad

2. Which item is a secondary risk of switching to an untested replacement supplier?

A. The unchanged historical 30% entry before the miss was confirmed.
B. The action of recording the current issue identifier.
C. New integration uncertainty introduced by the replacement.
D. The original supplier's already confirmed October 12 miss.

Answers and explanations, page 124

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20. Separate the response owner, proposed contingency, and evidence needed for closure.

Escalation should explain the need for help

A senior audience needs the confirmed problem, the threatened objective, and the decision or support required. A register entry is not a response plan. Avoid keeping an outdated probability merely because the final delivery date and full project impact are not yet known.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

A confirmed miss, an uncertain replacement

A vendor confirms it cannot deliver Tuesday. Thursday is suggested but not committed. A Wednesday test needs the item. No alternative is approved.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

approved / dependency / confirmed / uncommitted

01 **Manager:** Tuesday's miss is [1] _____.

02 **Buyer:** Thursday remains [2] _____.

03 **Manager:** The Wednesday test has a delivery [3] _____.

04 **Buyer:** No alternative has been [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. confirmed / **2.** uncommitted / **3.** dependency / **4.** approved

Why these answers fit, page 124

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility". Rina: "There may be a contingency in the procurement plan, but we should check its conditions and availability before saying it has solved the problem." Omar: [missing response] Rina: "If we expedite or switch sources, we may create new costs or quality questions. The escalation should not present every response as an uncomplicated improvement." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Those are potential secondary risks. Assess them alongside the remaining exposure from the original delay, and keep the response options comparable on a stated basis.

B. That is a useful escalation brief. It gives the decision maker something to act on rather than a long register entry with no clear request.

C. Exactly. A contingency plan must be usable under the current facts. A named alternative is not automatically available, qualified, authorized, or fast enough for the test.

D. State the impact carefully. The planned test is threatened by the confirmed miss, but we still need a supported assessment of the full milestone consequence.

Answers and explanations, page 125

A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / STAKEHOLDER ALIGNMENT AND GOVERNANCE

Close a governance meeting with a clear decision status, accountable authority, and accurate record of recommendations and actions.

> **A recommendation is not an approval**
>
> Project manager Rae reviews meeting notes with steering-group chair Simon. The group recommended changing a release feature, but the notes say change approved. The project governance plan reserves this change decision to the sponsor; no written delegation or sponsor decision is recorded. The group can recommend and commission analysis. Rae must correct the minutes, identify the approval route, and separate an action to prepare an assessment from authority to implement the feature change.

People: Rae, Project manager; Simon, Steering-group chair.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Who holds the stated change authority?

A. An unnamed vendor
B. The sponsor
C. Every meeting attendee independently
D. The note taker automatically

2. What did the steering group actually do?

A. Record a sponsor approval
B. Supply a written delegation
C. Implement the feature change
D. Recommend a change

3. What may the group commission under the supplied remit?

A. Unrestricted implementation of the change
B. A false approval record
C. A replacement of the sponsor's reserved authority
D. Analysis of the proposal

Answers and explanations, page 126

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

governance
The arrangements for project direction, decisions, oversight, and accountability.

clarify project governance

terms of reference
The document defining a group's purpose, membership, and remit.

check the terms of reference

change authority
The person or body empowered to authorize a specified change.

identify the change authority

approval threshold
A boundary determining the level of authorization required.

apply the approval threshold

recommendation
A proposed course of action submitted for consideration.

record a recommendation

authorization
Permission from the appropriate authority to take the stated action.

obtain authorization

steering group
A group guiding the project within its defined authority.

convene the steering group

remit
The area of responsibility and authority assigned to a person or group.

stay within the remit

delegated authority
Decision power explicitly assigned by an authorized person or body.

verify delegated authority

decision rights
Defined responsibility for making particular decisions.

confirm decision rights

endorsement
Expressed support that may not itself constitute formal approval.

distinguish endorsement from approval

quorum
The minimum participation required for a body's valid proceedings under its rules.

confirm a quorum

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

governance GOVERNANCE

clarify project governance

Keep the meaning precise: The arrangements for project direction, decisions, oversight, and accountability.

delegated authority DELEGATED AUTHORITY

verify delegated authority

Keep the meaning precise: Decision power explicitly assigned by an authorized person or body.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

consensus

Broad agreement among participants on a stated matter.

establish the scope of consensus

dissent

A stated disagreement with a proposal or conclusion.

record material dissent

decision log

A record of actual decisions, authority, conditions, and dates.

maintain the decision log

action log

A record of assigned tasks, owners, deadlines, and status.

update the action log

minutes

The formal record of a meeting's relevant proceedings and outcomes.

correct the minutes

escalation route

The path for referring a matter beyond the current authority.

use the escalation route

stage gate

A defined review point for an authorization or continuation decision.

prepare for a stage gate

assurance review

An examination intended to provide confidence in delivery or controls.

commission an assurance review

accountability

Answerability for a defined decision or result.

assign accountability

RACI

A responsibility model distinguishing responsible, accountable, consulted, and informed roles.

clarify the RACI roles

decision paper

A document presenting the issue, options, consequences, and requested decision.

prepare a decision paper

conditional approval

Authorization limited by explicit conditions.

record conditional approval

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

quorum QUORUM

confirm a quorum

Keep the meaning precise: The minimum participation required for a body's valid proceedings under its rules.

minutes MINUTES

correct the minutes

Keep the meaning precise: The formal record of a meeting's relevant proceedings and outcomes.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Check the record

The minutes say approved, but the group made a recommendation.

Ask about delegation

Is there an explicit delegation covering this change?

Clarify the remit

The group can recommend and commission analysis.

Frame the request

The sponsor needs the options, impacts, and specific decision sought.

Correct the status

Mark the change as recommended, with approval pending.

Keep delivery informed

Tell the team exactly what work is authorized meanwhile.

Check a condition

State what must happen before a conditional approval takes effect.

Keep the records distinct

Put decisions in the decision log and tasks in the action log.

Name the authority

The governance plan reserves this decision to the sponsor.

Separate agreement

Consensus here does not by itself provide implementation authority.

Distinguish the action

Preparing the assessment is not approval to implement.

Preserve dissent

Record material objections accurately rather than inventing unanimity.

Assign the preparation

Name the owner and deadline for the decision paper.

Avoid a silent decision

No objection in the meeting is not a recorded sponsor approval.

Confirm the outcome

Read back the decision, authority, limits, and action owners.

Close the route

Send the recommendation through the defined approval route.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Separate agreement
Useful wording: Consensus here does not by itself provide implementation authority.

Purpose: Clarify the remit
Useful wording: The group can recommend and commission analysis.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which correction belongs in the minutes?

A. All decision rights transferred automatically to the chair

B. Change recommended; sponsor approval pending; analysis commissioned

C. Sponsor approved despite no recorded decision

D. Change implemented because the room agreed

2. The group is quorate and unanimous. What remains necessary before implementing this change?

A. Nothing further, because a quorum approves any proposal discussed.

B. An updated task list, because analysis authority includes implementation authority.

C. Sponsor approval or an explicit applicable delegation; quorum and agreement do not enlarge the stated remit.

D. Only the chair's signature, because unanimity transfers the sponsor's authority.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The area of responsibility and authority assigned to a person or group. Which term fits?

A. decision log

B. remit

C. accountability

D. recommendation

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A recommendation is not an approval". Simon: "Then I should tell the team we support the recommendation, but we have not authorized the build. Can you point me to the decision authority in our plan?" Rae: [missing response] Simon: "There may be a delegation somewhere, but I have not seen one. I should not ask the team to proceed on the assumption that it probably exists." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Put that in the action log. The task is to prepare analysis with an owner and deadline; it is not an instruction to implement the feature change.

B. Exactly. Check the terms of reference. This group can recommend and commission analysis; it cannot treat its own enthusiasm as permission outside the authority the project has assigned.

C. A conditional approval must state the limits and what must be satisfied. We should not silently treat an unmet condition as though it has already been cleared.

D. Update the decision log accordingly and tell the delivery team the same status. A clear handoff will preserve both useful progress and the actual boundary on implementation.

Answers and explanations, page 126

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Consensus in the steering group does not override the sponsor authority stated in this case. A quorum only answers whether the group can validly conduct its own business; it does not enlarge its remit or create an unrecorded delegation.

E Conversation

A recommendation is not an approval

A recommendation is not an approval

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

delegated authority / dissent / authorization / terms of reference / decision log / decision paper / quorum / conditional approval / action log / recommendation

01 **Simon:** The meeting seemed aligned on changing the feature, and the notes say change approved. I assumed that reflected the room, but you have flagged the wording.

02 **Rae:** The room made a [1] _____. Our governance plan reserves this decision to the sponsor, and the record contains neither a sponsor decision nor an explicit delegation.

03 **Simon:** We had enough members present and everyone supported the proposal. Does that not give the group authority to move the change forward?

04 **Rae:** A [2] _____ lets the group conduct business under its rules. It does not expand the remit or replace a decision explicitly reserved to someone else.

05 **Simon:** Then I should tell the team we support the recommendation, but we have not authorized the build. Can you point me to the decision authority in our plan?

06 **Rae:** Exactly. Check the [3] _____. This group can recommend and commission analysis; it cannot treat its own enthusiasm as permission outside the authority the project has assigned.

07 **Simon:** There may be a delegation somewhere, but I have not seen one. I should not ask the team to proceed on the assumption that it probably exists.

08 **Rae:** Verify [4] _____ before relying on it. Until then, the sponsor remains the stated decision maker for this change, and the implementation status should remain pending.

09 **Simon:** We did assign someone to assess the impact. I want that work to proceed, because the sponsor will need a clearer comparison of the options.

10 **Rae:** Put that in the [5] _____. The task is to prepare analysis with an owner and deadline; it is not an instruction to implement the feature change.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A recommendation is not an approval

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Simon:** What should the sponsor receive? Sending the meeting transcript would show the discussion, but might not make the actual choice very clear.

12 **Rae:** Prepare a [6] _____. Include the options, consequences, recommendation, and specific authorization sought, along with the date when the decision is needed for delivery planning.

13 **Simon:** I will correct the minutes to say recommended rather than approved. Should we also explain that the analysis is authorized while implementation is not?

14 **Rae:** Yes. Keep [7] _____ attached to the specific action. Otherwise the team may hear that work can proceed and assume that means the change itself.

15 **Simon:** Keep the material objections in the paper too. The sponsor needs to see the concerns we discussed, not just a tidy statement that everyone agreed.

16 **Rae:** Record material [8] _____ accurately. The sponsor needs the substantive concerns, not a smoother account that hides the trade-off the group actually discussed.

17 **Simon:** If the sponsor later approves with conditions, the delivery team needs those conditions too. The word approved on its own would still be incomplete.

18 **Rae:** A [9] _____ must state the limits and what must be satisfied. We should not silently treat an unmet condition as though it has already been cleared.

19 **Simon:** I will read back the corrected result: recommendation supported, assessment commissioned, sponsor decision pending. Then we will send the paper through the stated route.

20 **Rae:** Update the [10] _____ accordingly and tell the delivery team the same status. A clear handoff will preserve both useful progress and the actual boundary on implementation.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. recommendation / **2.** quorum / **3.** terms of reference / **4.** delegated authority / **5.** action log / **6.** decision paper / **7.** authorization / **8.** dissent / **9.** conditional approval / **10.** decision log

Why these answers fit, page 128

F Check accuracy and scope

A recommendation is not an approval

Return to the case

Project manager Rae reviews meeting notes with steering-group chair Simon. The group recommended changing a release feature, but the notes say change approved. The project governance plan reserves this change decision to the sponsor; no written delegation or sponsor decision is recorded. The group can recommend and commission analysis. Rae must correct the minutes, identify the approval route, and separate an action to prepare an assessment from authority to implement the feature change.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which task can proceed under the supplied facts?

A. Implementing the proposed feature change as approved
B. Announcing a sponsor decision that is absent
C. Erasing the approval requirement from the record
D. Preparing the commissioned impact analysis

2. Which record best captures conditional approval if it is later given?

A. The actual approver, permitted change, explicit conditions, and condition status
B. Only the word approved without limits
C. A claim that every possible change is authorized
D. A recommendation relabeled as approval before the sponsor acts

Answers and explanations, page 129

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20. Read the authorized analysis action without turning it into an implementation instruction.

Ask the authority question before the room empties

A meeting can reach a strong recommendation without having the authority to implement it. Clarify what was decided, who can authorize the next step, and what the team may do meanwhile. This prevents a cooperative discussion from becoming an ambiguous instruction passed to delivery teams.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Authorize analysis, not implementation

A committee may commission analysis but cannot approve a cost change. It recommends an option and requests an assessment. The finance sponsor has not decided.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

pending / assessment / authorized / recommendation

01 **Chair:** The committee has made a [1] _____.

02 **Manager:** The authorized next task is the [2] _____.

03 **Chair:** The sponsor's decision is still [3] _____.

04 **Manager:** Implementation is not yet [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. recommendation / **2.** assessment / **3.** pending / **4.** authorized

Why these answers fit, page 129

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A recommendation is not an approval". Simon: "I will correct the minutes to say recommended rather than approved. Should we also explain that the analysis is authorized while implementation is not?" Rae: [missing response] Simon: "Keep the material objections in the paper too. The sponsor needs to see the concerns we discussed, not just a tidy statement that everyone agreed." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Prepare a decision paper. Include the options, consequences, recommendation, and specific authorization sought, along with the date when the decision is needed for delivery planning.

B. A quorum lets the group conduct business under its rules. It does not expand the remit or replace a decision explicitly reserved to someone else.

C. The room made a recommendation. Our governance plan reserves this decision to the sponsor, and the record contains neither a sponsor decision nor an explicit delegation.

D. Yes. Keep authorization attached to the specific action. Otherwise the team may hear that work can proceed and assume that means the change itself.

Answers and explanations, page 130

Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Risk Register and Issue Escalation" and "Stakeholder Alignment and Governance". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Uncertainty with a potentially beneficial effect on an objective. Which term fits?

A. opportunity
B. mitigation
C. action owner
D. escalation brief

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Defined responsibility for making particular decisions. Which term fits?

A. governance
B. stage gate
C. decision rights
D. consensus

3. Rebuild the exchange from "One late task can move the release". Anika: "I will show end of day eleven against end of day eight. These are working-day numbers, not three ordinary dates on a calendar." Luis: [missing response] Anika: "Another team says its tasks have four days available. Could I transfer those four days to testing and cancel our three-day delay?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. Keep the working calendar consistent. A weekend or holiday must be handled through the dated schedule, not silently counted differently between the two versions.
B. No. Their total float belongs to that schedule path. Spare time elsewhere does not change this chain's dependencies or create a buffer where none exists.
C. It is fast-tracking, because it overlaps previously sequential work. We need to assess what can overlap, whether the input is usable, and the resulting risk.
D. Not under this critical path. Testing must finish before rehearsal, and rehearsal before approval. That chain controls release, with no buffer in the simplified model.

Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A recommendation is not an approval". Simon: "If the sponsor later approves with conditions, the delivery team needs those conditions too. The word approved on its own would still be incomplete." Rae: [missing response] Simon: "I will read back the corrected result: recommendation supported, assessment commissioned, sponsor decision pending. Then we will send the paper through the stated route." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Put that in the action log. The task is to prepare analysis with an owner and deadline; it is not an instruction to implement the feature change.

B. Update the decision log accordingly and tell the delivery team the same status. A clear handoff will preserve both useful progress and the actual boundary on implementation.

C. The room made a recommendation. Our governance plan reserves this decision to the sponsor, and the record contains neither a sponsor decision nor an explicit delegation.

D. A conditional approval must state the limits and what must be satisfied. We should not silently treat an unmet condition as though it has already been cleared.

Answers and explanations, page 154

A Read the situation

LESSON 05 / CHANGE REQUESTS AND SCOPE CREEP

Respond constructively to a late scope request by comparing explicit options, effort, schedule effects, and approval status.

Just one more report before launch

Two weeks before launch, sponsor Nadia asks project manager Chen to add a new report. The current plan uses all 20 remaining person-days. The report is estimated at four person-days including testing. The team has assessed two feasible options: defer an existing four-person-day export feature and retain the launch date, or keep all features and extend the schedule by two working days using the planned team. Both need approval. No overtime, extra staff, or reduced testing is assumed.

People: Nadia, Project sponsor; Chen, Project manager.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. How much effort is estimated for the new report?

A. Twenty person-days of confirmed extra capacity
B. Four person-days including testing
C. Two person-days excluding testing
D. Zero because the report is requested late

2. Which assessed option retains the launch date?

A. Remove testing from the report
B. Defer the existing four-person-day export feature
C. Keep every feature with no other change
D. Add unapproved overtime automatically

3. What is the status of both options?

A. The new launch date is already the baseline.
B. They need approval.
C. Both are already approved simultaneously.
D. The export has already been removed.

Answers and explanations, page 131

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

change request
A recorded proposal to alter agreed project work or parameters.

raise a change request

change control
The process for assessing and deciding changes to an approved reference.

follow change control

scope creep
Uncontrolled growth in project work without corresponding assessment and authorization.

prevent scope creep

change log
A record of proposed and decided project changes.

update the change log

impact assessment
Analysis of how a proposal affects relevant project dimensions.

complete an impact assessment

effort estimate
The amount of work expected, expressed in person-time or another work unit.

qualify the effort estimate

person-day
One person's defined day of work used as an effort unit.

estimate effort in person-days

elapsed duration
The time passing from an activity's start to finish.

distinguish elapsed duration

capacity limit
The amount of work the stated resources can support.

explain the capacity limit

trade-off
A choice between competing benefits, costs, or constraints.

present the trade-off

scope substitution
Replacing one part of planned work with another under an authorized change.

assess a scope substitution

deferred feature
A capability moved out of the current delivery scope or timing.

identify the deferred feature

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

change request CHANGE REQUEST

raise a change request

Keep the meaning precise: A recorded proposal to alter agreed project work or parameters.

effort estimate EFFORT ESTIMATE

qualify the effort estimate

Keep the meaning precise: The amount of work expected, expressed in person-time or another work unit.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

incremental cost

Additional cost caused by the proposed change.

assess incremental cost

opportunity cost

Value forgone by choosing one use of resources over another.

explain the opportunity cost

benefit impact

The effect of a change on the value expected from the project.

assess benefit impact

rework

Work repeated or revised because of a change or defect.

estimate rework

test coverage

The extent to which specified requirements or conditions are tested.

preserve required test coverage

release boundary

The defined set of capabilities included in a particular release.

clarify the release boundary

change freeze

A point or period limiting changes under the project's stated rules.

apply the change-freeze rules

baseline revision

An authorized update to the controlled project reference.

record a baseline revision

approval record

Evidence of the actual authorization and its limits.

retain the approval record

implementation instruction

A clear direction specifying the authorized change to perform.

issue an implementation instruction

option comparison

An assessment of alternatives on a consistent basis.

prepare an option comparison

decision latency

Time between needing a decision and receiving it.

account for decision latency

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

deferred feature DEFERRED FEATURE

identify the deferred feature

Keep the meaning precise: A capability moved out of the current delivery scope or timing.

test coverage TEST COVERAGE

preserve required test coverage

Keep the meaning precise: The extent to which specified requirements or conditions are tested.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the value

I understand why the new report would be useful at launch.

Quantify the addition

The report is estimated at four person-days including testing.

Present the substitution

We can retain the date by deferring the existing export feature.

Name the lost capability

The substitution means the export is not in this release.

Protect the decision

We need approval before changing the committed scope or date.

Compare consequences

Review the timing and benefit effects on the same basis.

Record the request

Put the new report and its impacts in the change record.

Preserve the baseline

Update the controlled plan only after the actual decision.

State the current limit

The plan already uses all 20 remaining person-days.

Avoid unit confusion

Effort is four person-days; the assessed extension is two working days.

Present the timing option

We can keep all features with the assessed two-working-day extension.

Keep assumptions visible

Neither option assumes extra staff, overtime, or reduced testing.

Separate value and capacity

A valuable request still consumes delivery effort.

Avoid a hidden shortcut

Removing required testing is not one of the assessed options.

Check decision timing

A late decision may require the estimates to be refreshed.

Close the choice

Confirm which option is approved and what the team should implement.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Avoid unit confusion
Useful wording: Effort is four person-days; the assessed extension is two working days.

Purpose: Present the substitution
Useful wording: We can retain the date by deferring the existing export feature.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which option summary preserves the assessed trade-offs?

A. Retain the export and date by treating four person-days as two person-days of work.

B. Retain all features and the date because the report's testing is already included.

C. Defer the export and report unchanged scope because both features require four person-days.

D. Defer the four-person-day export to retain the date, or keep all features with the assessed two-working-day extension; approval is pending.

2. Why does the four-person-day estimate not mean a four-day extension here?

A. The original plan contains unlimited unused capacity.

B. Effort and elapsed duration differ; the assessed team plan gives two working days.

C. Person-days are the same as calendar days in every case.

D. Testing has been excluded without disclosure.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A record of proposed and decided project changes. Which term fits?

A. capacity limit

B. approval record

C. change log

D. benefit impact

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Just one more report before launch". Nadia: "Please explain those options in terms of the launch and what users will receive. That will help me compare the value instead of debating whether four is a big number." Chen: [missing response] Nadia: "The date stays, but users lose the export from this release. Please put that beside the new report so nobody reads this as an addition with no loss." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The first is a scope substitution. Defer the existing four-person-day export feature and use that capacity for the new report, retaining the launch date.

B. The effort estimate is four person-days including testing. The team has assessed two options using the planned people, with no extra staff or overtime assumed.

C. Exactly. Assess the benefit impact of deferring the export. A date-preserving option still changes the release content and may affect the work users can do.

D. That is the option comparison. Include the assumptions and any relevant consequences so the decision is about the actual alternatives, not a more attractive label.

Answers and explanations, page 131

One useful distinction

Four person-days is effort; two working days is an assessed schedule extension with the planned team. They are not interchangeable units. The supplied options already include testing and assume no extra staff or overtime.

E Conversation

Just one more report before launch

Just one more report before launch

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

change request / elapsed duration / decision latency / scope substitution / benefit impact / effort estimate / test coverage / option comparison / baseline revision / approval record

01 **Nadia:** Could we add one more report before launch? It would be useful for the operations review, and I hope it is a small enough change to fit.

02 **Chen:** Let us record the [1] _____. The current plan already uses all twenty remaining person-days, so the report cannot be treated as an addition with no consequence.

03 **Nadia:** I understand it needs work. What does the estimate include? I do not want a build estimate that leaves testing to become a surprise later.

04 **Chen:** The [2] _____ is four person-days including testing. The team has assessed two options using the planned people, with no extra staff or overtime assumed.

05 **Nadia:** Please explain those options in terms of the launch and what users will receive. That will help me compare the value instead of debating whether four is a big number.

06 **Chen:** The first is a [3] _____. Defer the existing four-person-day export feature and use that capacity for the new report, retaining the launch date.

07 **Nadia:** The date stays, but users lose the export from this release. Please put that beside the new report so nobody reads this as an addition with no loss.

08 **Chen:** Exactly. Assess the [4] _____ of deferring the export. A date-preserving option still changes the release content and may affect the work users can do.

09 **Nadia:** What is the second option if the export remains important enough that we should not remove it from this release?

10 **Chen:** Keep all features and accept the assessed [5] _____ increase of two working days. That is the team's schedule assessment, not a claim that four person-days always equals two days.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Just one more report before launch

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Nadia:** Both options include the same testing expectation, correct? I would not want an apparently unchanged date achieved by quietly leaving out required checks.

12 **Chen:** Correct. We have not reduced [6] _____ to create either option. If someone proposes a different approach, it needs its own assessment rather than being smuggled into the estimate.

13 **Nadia:** We should compare the two options together: date retained with export deferred, or all features retained with a later launch. Neither means no trade-off.

14 **Chen:** That is the [7] _____. Include the assumptions and any relevant consequences so the decision is about the actual alternatives, not a more attractive label.

15 **Nadia:** I am not choosing an option in this conversation yet. I need to confirm the export's importance with the operations lead before making the decision.

16 **Chen:** Then the [8] _____ should remain pending. The delivery team should not infer an instruction to remove the export or move the date from our discussion of possibilities.

17 **Nadia:** How long is this comparison valid? If the team starts the export before I decide, I assume we need to revisit the estimate rather than reuse it unchanged.

18 **Chen:** We must account for [9] _____. Confirm a decision checkpoint with the team; if the work has moved on, refresh the assessment rather than reuse an estimate whose assumptions no longer hold.

19 **Nadia:** Once the decision is made, we should tell stakeholders exactly what changed. I do not want one audience expecting the original export and another expecting the new report.

20 **Chen:** Issue the authorized [10] _____ and implementation instruction together. That gives the team and stakeholders one supported version of the release instead of several incompatible promises.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. change request / **2.** effort estimate / **3.** scope substitution / **4.** benefit impact / **5.** elapsed duration / **6.** test coverage / **7.** option comparison / **8.** approval record / **9.** decision latency / **10.** baseline revision

Why these answers fit, page 132

F Check accuracy and scope

Just one more report before launch

Return to the case

Two weeks before launch, sponsor Nadia asks project manager Chen to add a new report. The current plan uses all 20 remaining person-days. The report is estimated at four person-days including testing. The team has assessed two feasible options: defer an existing four-person-day export feature and retain the launch date, or keep all features and extend the schedule by two working days using the planned team. Both need approval. No overtime, extra staff, or reduced testing is assumed.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What must the date-preserving option disclose?

A. Every original capability remains unchanged.
B. The new report needs no testing.
C. The scope baseline has already been revised.
D. The existing export will be deferred from this release.

2. What turns an addition into uncontrolled scope creep?

A. Implementing extra work without the required assessment and authorization
B. Recording and approving a supported change
C. Comparing options before a decision
D. Updating the baseline after proper approval

Answers and explanations, page 134

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Present the export substitution and schedule extension, keeping testing and approval conditions unchanged.

A constructive boundary includes options

A sponsor may hear an immediate no as resistance, but an unqualified yes can conceal a delivery problem. Acknowledge the value, explain the capacity limit, and present the assessed options. The decision is about priorities and consequences, not whether the team is sufficiently willing.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

A substitution changes scope

A new feature needs three person-days. The assessed date-preserving option removes another three-person-day feature. Both cannot fit under the unchanged plan, and no option is approved.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

effort / deferred / substitution / approval

01 **Sponsor:** The new feature requires three person-days of [1] _____.

02 **Manager:** Keeping the date requires the assessed scope [2] _____.

03 **Sponsor:** The original feature would be [3] _____.

04 **Manager:** The option still needs [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. effort / **2.** substitution / **3.** deferred / **4.** approval

Why these answers fit, page 134

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Just one more report before launch". Nadia: "We should compare the two options together: date retained with export deferred, or all features retained with a later launch. Neither means no trade-off." Chen: [missing response] Nadia: "I am not choosing an option in this conversation yet. I need to confirm the export's importance with the operations lead before making the decision." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Assess the benefit impact of deferring the export. A date-preserving option still changes the release content and may affect the work users can do.

B. The effort estimate is four person-days including testing. The team has assessed two options using the planned people, with no extra staff or overtime assumed.

C. That is the option comparison. Include the assumptions and any relevant consequences so the decision is about the actual alternatives, not a more attractive label.

D. The first is a scope substitution. Defer the existing four-person-day export feature and use that capacity for the new report, retaining the launch date.

Answers and explanations, page 135

A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / STATUS REPORTING AND EXECUTIVE UPDATES

Produce a concise executive update that shows material threats, rating criteria, and decision needs without confusing task counts with delivery confidence.

Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened

Project lead Sofia and sponsor James review a green report. Eight of ten tasks are complete, but the remaining access approval is needed by October 9 for an October 12 rehearsal before the planned October 16 launch. Approval is unconfirmed. The fictional reporting rules require amber when a material threat needs management attention and green only when delivery is on track without such a threat. No effort weights, cost data, approved recovery, or confirmed launch delay are supplied.

People: Sofia, Project lead; James, Project sponsor.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What does eight of ten establish?

A. The final access approval is already granted.
B. Eighty percent of the task count is complete.
C. Eighty percent of all effort is complete.
D. The launch date is guaranteed.

2. Why does the access approval matter?

A. It proves all ten tasks are finished.
B. It replaces every release decision.
C. It is needed for the rehearsal that precedes launch.
D. It is unrelated to remaining work.

3. Which rating matches the supplied rules and facts?

A. Automatically red because any uncertainty means failure
B. No rating because the threat is not yet a confirmed delay
C. Amber
D. Green because most task boxes are complete

Answers and explanations, page 136

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

status report
A periodic account of progress, outlook, problems, and decisions needed.

prepare a status report

status date
The date to which the reported information applies.

state the status date

reporting period
The time interval covered by a report.

define the reporting period

RAG rating
A red-amber-green status classification under stated criteria.

apply the RAG rating

green status
An on-track classification under the project's defined reporting rules.

justify green status

amber status
A warning classification requiring attention under the defined rules.

explain amber status

red status
A serious-problem classification under the defined reporting rules.

explain red status

delivery confidence
An assessment of the likelihood of achieving the intended delivery outcome.

assess delivery confidence

key milestone
A major event used to judge project progress or readiness.

report a key milestone

dependency owner
The person accountable for managing a required external or linked input.

identify the dependency owner

dependency due date
The date a required input must be available for the plan.

confirm the dependency due date

leading indicator
A signal of a possible future result or problem.

monitor a leading indicator

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

status report STATUS REPORT

prepare a status report

Keep the meaning precise: A periodic account of progress, outlook, problems, and decisions needed.

amber status AMBER STATUS

explain amber status

Keep the meaning precise: A warning classification requiring attention under the defined rules.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

lagging indicator

A measure of an outcome that has already occurred.

distinguish a lagging indicator

exception report

A focused report on a deviation or condition requiring attention.

raise an exception report

percent complete

Completion expressed as a percentage under a specified measurement basis.

define percent complete

task-count completion

The share of listed tasks marked complete without weighting their effort.

qualify task-count completion

weighted progress

Progress calculated using stated effort, value, or other weights.

report weighted progress

earned value

The budgeted value of work actually completed under a defined measurement method.

distinguish earned value

planned value

The budgeted value of work planned by the status date.

compare with planned value

actual cost

Cost incurred for the work under the stated accounting basis.

report actual cost

cost performance index

Earned value divided by actual cost, commonly CPI.

interpret the cost performance index

schedule performance index

Earned value divided by planned value, commonly SPI.

interpret the schedule performance index

confidence qualifier

Wording that states a forecast's uncertainty or conditions.

add a confidence qualifier

executive ask

The specific decision or support requested from senior management.

state the executive ask

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

leading indicator LEADING INDICATOR

monitor a leading indicator

Keep the meaning precise: A signal of a possible future result or problem.

weighted progress WEIGHTED PROGRESS

report weighted progress

Keep the meaning precise: Progress calculated using stated effort, value, or other weights.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Lead with the exception

The access dependency threatens the planned launch sequence.

Keep progress visible

Eight of ten listed tasks are complete.

Name the missing input

The access approval is still unconfirmed.

Connect the milestone

Rehearsal is planned for October 12 before the October 16 launch.

Avoid a false green

Completed tasks do not remove the remaining dependency.

State the executive ask

We need help securing a timely decision through the authorized route.

Separate data gaps

These task counts do not provide earned-value or cost information.

Report change honestly

Update the outlook when evidence changes, not when a color becomes uncomfortable.

State the rating basis

Our rules require amber for a material threat needing management attention.

Qualify the percentage

That is task-count completion, not weighted effort.

Give the needed-by date

We need that approval by October 9.

Avoid unsupported certainty

The launch is not yet confirmed delayed, but the threat is material.

Name the owner

Identify who is responsible for obtaining the approval.

Keep the baseline visible

The planned launch remains October 16 pending further evidence or approval.

Set the checkpoint

Confirm when the approval status will next be reviewed.

Close in one sequence

Rating, dependency, impact, owner, needed action, next update.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Qualify the percentage
Useful wording: That is task-count completion, not weighted effort.

Purpose: Name the missing input
Useful wording: The access approval is still unconfirmed.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which executive summary is best supported?

A. Amber: access due October 9 is unconfirmed; rehearsal and launch are exposed; owner and decision follow-up needed.

B. Green: 80% of tasks means 80% certainty of launch.

C. Red: October 16 is definitely impossible on the supplied facts.

D. All work is complete except tasks that do not matter.

2. Why is "80% of the project is done" too broad?

A. Eight divided by ten is not 80%.

B. Every task must have identical effort by definition.

C. The count proves all remaining tasks are optional.

D. Only unweighted task counts are supplied.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A red-amber-green status classification under stated criteria. Which term fits?

A. percent complete

B. RAG rating

C. key milestone

D. cost performance index

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened". James: "Please state the dates in the short update. I need to see the point at which the missing approval affects the rest of the plan." Sofia: [missing response] James: "We do not yet know that launch will be late, though. I want the report to show the threat without declaring a final outcome the evidence does not establish." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. That is task-count completion, not eighty percent of all effort or readiness. The remaining tasks may differ in size, and one contains the input needed for rehearsal.

B. Use a confidence qualifier: October sixteenth remains planned, but the access dependency is unconfirmed and threatens the sequence. No recovery or revised date has been approved.

C. The dependency due date is October ninth. Rehearsal is planned for October twelfth, ahead of the October sixteenth launch, so the approval cannot remain an unrelated footnote.

D. Yes. Our RAG rating should reflect that dependency. The supplied rules require amber when a material threat needs management attention, even before a milestone is confirmed late.

Answers and explanations, page 136

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Eight of ten means 80% of task count, not necessarily 80% of effort, value, or readiness. Unequal task sizes and a controlling dependency make that distinction important. No earned-value or cost-performance result can be calculated from these counts alone.

E Conversation

Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened

Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

dependency due date / status date / confidence qualifier / Earned value / Delivery confidence / exception report / dependency owner / task-count completion / executive ask / RAG rating

01 **James:** The report is green and shows eight of ten tasks complete. That sounds encouraging, but I see the access approval is still open. Does it affect the rehearsal?

02 **Sofia:** Yes. Our [1] _____ should reflect that dependency. The supplied rules require amber when a material threat needs management attention, even before a milestone is confirmed late.

03 **James:** Keep the eight completed tasks in the update, but put the access problem first. Which unfinished task is driving the threat to rehearsal?

04 **Sofia:** Exactly. That is [2] _____, not eighty percent of all effort or readiness. The remaining tasks may differ in size, and one contains the input needed for rehearsal.

05 **James:** Please state the dates in the short update. I need to see the point at which the missing approval affects the rest of the plan.

06 **Sofia:** The [3] _____ is October ninth. Rehearsal is planned for October twelfth, ahead of the October sixteenth launch, so the approval cannot remain an unrelated footnote.

E Conversation / continued

07 **James:** We do not yet know that launch will be late, though. I want the report to show the threat without declaring a final outcome the evidence does not establish.

08 **Sofia:** Use a [4] _____: October sixteenth remains planned, but the access dependency is unconfirmed and threatens the sequence. No recovery or revised date has been approved.

09 **James:** Who is responsible for obtaining the approval? A clear owner would help me understand where support is needed instead of sending a general chase to everyone.

10 **Sofia:** Identify the [5] _____ and the authorized decision route. The report should say who is following up, what decision is required, and when the next status check will occur.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **James:** I can help bring the decision to the right forum, but I cannot treat the urgency as permission to bypass the access approval itself.

12 **Sofia:** That is the appropriate [6] _____. We need support securing a timely decision through the proper route, not an assurance that an unapproved input can be treated as available.

13 **James:** The report also uses the words value delivered beside the eighty-percent figure. We do not have an earned-value calculation here, do we?

14 **Sofia:** No. [7] _____ needs its defined work and budget basis. The task count supplies neither that measure nor the actual cost needed for a cost-performance calculation.

15 **James:** Remove the unsupported value label. Give me progress, the access threat, the needed decision, and the deadline in one short update for the sponsor group.

16 **Sofia:** An [8] _____ can make that concise. It should expose the access issue without forcing the sponsor to discover it inside a long list of activities that are already finished.

17 **James:** I agree that amber follows our rules. It is not a punishment for the team; it tells us where management attention can still make a difference.

18 **Sofia:** Correct. [9] _____ depends on the remaining work and dependencies, not just historical completion. The rating should change when the relevant evidence changes.

Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened / continued

19 **James:** Please correct the report and confirm the next checkpoint. Keep the October sixteenth baseline visible while distinguishing it from any later forecast we may need.

20 **Sofia:** I will state the [10] _____ and current approval position, change the rating to amber, and include the owner and decision follow-up. That gives the next audience the same accurate picture.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. RAG rating / **2.** task-count completion / **3.** dependency due date / **4.** confidence qualifier / **5.** dependency owner / **6.** executive ask / **7.** Earned value / **8.** exception report / **9.** Delivery confidence / **10.** status date

Why these answers fit, page 137

F Check accuracy and scope

Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened

Return to the case

Project lead Sofia and sponsor James review a green report. Eight of ten tasks are complete, but the remaining access approval is needed by October 9 for an October 12 rehearsal before the planned October 16 launch. Approval is unconfirmed. The fictional reporting rules require amber when a material threat needs management attention and green only when delivery is on track without such a threat. No effort weights, cost data, approved recovery, or confirmed launch delay are supplied.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. A colleague divides eight completed tasks by ten total tasks and labels 0.8 as CPI. What is missing?

A. Only the planned release date and number of remaining meetings.

B. Nothing; an unweighted completion fraction is always the cost performance index.

C. Earned value and actual cost under a defined measurement basis.

D. Only the number of tasks marked green.

2. Which wording preserves uncertainty accurately?

A. No update is needed until after the date is missed.

B. October 16 remains planned, but the unconfirmed dependency creates a material threat.

C. October 16 is guaranteed because it is printed in the plan.

D. October 16 has definitely failed because a threat exists.

Answers and explanations, page 139

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Apply the supplied amber rule without asserting either guaranteed launch or a confirmed delay.

A color should invite the right conversation

Use the agreed reporting rules rather than choosing the color that sounds most reassuring. A material threat can require attention before a date is actually missed. A concise update should identify the dependency, consequence, owner, and needed action, not hide the problem behind a long list of completed work.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Counted progress does not remove a blocker

Six of eight tasks are complete. A material dependency remains open. The local rules require amber for that threat, and no final delay is confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

seventy-five / amber / confirmed / progress

01 **Lead:** Task-count completion is [1] _____ percent.

02 **Sponsor:** That does not establish weighted [2] _____.

03 **Lead:** Under our rules, the rating is [3] _____.

04 **Sponsor:** A final delay is not yet [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. seventy-five / **2.** progress / **3.** amber / **4.** confirmed

Why these answers fit, page 139

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened". James: "The report also uses the words value delivered beside the eighty-percent figure. We do not have an earned-value calculation here, do we?" Sofia: [missing response] James: "Remove the unsupported value label. Give me progress, the access threat, the needed decision, and the deadline in one short update for the sponsor group." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. Our RAG rating should reflect that dependency. The supplied rules require amber when a material threat needs management attention, even before a milestone is confirmed late.

B. The dependency due date is October ninth. Rehearsal is planned for October twelfth, ahead of the October sixteenth launch, so the approval cannot remain an unrelated footnote.

C. No. Earned value needs its defined work and budget basis. The task count supplies neither that measure nor the actual cost needed for a cost-performance calculation.

D. Use a confidence qualifier: October sixteenth remains planned, but the access dependency is unconfirmed and threatens the sequence. No recovery or revised date has been approved.

Answers and explanations, page 140

Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Change Requests and Scope Creep" and "Status Reporting and Executive Updates". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Uncontrolled growth in project work without corresponding assessment and authorization. Which term fits?

A. opportunity cost
B. baseline revision
C. elapsed duration
D. scope creep

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An assessment of the likelihood of achieving the intended delivery outcome. Which term fits?

A. lagging indicator
B. delivery confidence
C. status report
D. planned value

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A recommendation is not an approval". Simon: "We did assign someone to assess the impact. I want that work to proceed, because the sponsor will need a clearer comparison of the options." Rae: [missing response] Simon: "What should the sponsor receive? Sending the meeting transcript would show the discussion, but might not make the actual choice very clear." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Update the decision log accordingly and tell the delivery team the same status. A clear handoff will preserve both useful progress and the actual boundary on implementation.
B. The room made a recommendation. Our governance plan reserves this decision to the sponsor, and the record contains neither a sponsor decision nor an explicit delegation.
C. A conditional approval must state the limits and what must be satisfied. We should not silently treat an unmet condition as though it has already been cleared.
D. Put that in the action log. The task is to prepare analysis with an owner and deadline; it is not an instruction to implement the feature change.

Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened". James: "I agree that amber follows our rules. It is not a punishment for the team; it tells us where management attention can still make a difference." Sofia: [missing response] James: "Please correct the report and confirm the next checkpoint. Keep the October sixteenth baseline visible while distinguishing it from any later forecast we may need." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. Our RAG rating should reflect that dependency. The supplied rules require amber when a material threat needs management attention, even before a milestone is confirmed late.

B. No. Earned value needs its defined work and budget basis. The task count supplies neither that measure nor the actual cost needed for a cost-performance calculation.

C. Use a confidence qualifier: October sixteenth remains planned, but the access dependency is unconfirmed and threatens the sequence. No recovery or revised date has been approved.

D. Correct. Delivery confidence depends on the remaining work and dependencies, not just historical completion. The rating should change when the relevant evidence changes.

Answers and explanations, page 157

A Read the situation

LESSON 07 / VENDOR AND CROSS-FUNCTIONAL DELIVERY

Resolve a delivery-status disagreement by linking agreed criteria to evidence, distinguishing missing proof from failure, and naming the acceptance authority.

> **Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted**
>
> Vendor lead Marta says a workflow deliverable is complete. Client acceptance lead Leo can verify four of six agreed criteria, but finds no evidence for C5, audit-log export, or C6, role-based access behavior. The missing evidence does not itself prove those functions fail. No acceptance or waiver is recorded, and Leo cannot waive criteria alone. Contractual payment consequences have not been assessed. Leo and Marta must agree the evidence handoff without adding new scope or treating the delivery claim as acceptance.

People: Leo, Client acceptance lead; Marta, Vendor delivery lead.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. How many criteria currently have verified evidence?

A. Two of six
B. None
C. Four of six
D. All six

2. What follows from missing evidence for C5 and C6?

A. Both criteria are automatically waived.
B. The client has accepted all work.
C. Their compliance has not yet been demonstrated in the record.
D. Both functions are proven defective.

3. Who may waive the criteria under the supplied facts?

A. The appropriate authority, which Leo cannot replace alone
B. Leo automatically because the vendor says complete
C. Any observer at a demonstration
D. No authorization is ever relevant

Answers and explanations, page 141

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

statement of work
The agreed description of the vendor's work and deliverables, commonly SOW.

refer to the statement of work

deliverable register
A record of promised outputs and their current status.

update the deliverable register

acceptance plan
The arrangement for checking and deciding acceptance of outputs.

confirm the acceptance plan

acceptance authority
The person or body empowered to accept the deliverable.

identify the acceptance authority

acceptance evidence
Information demonstrating whether the agreed criteria are met.

supply acceptance evidence

requirements matrix
A table linking requirements to identifiers, status, or supporting information.

review the requirements matrix

evidence gap
Missing information needed to support a conclusion.

identify an evidence gap

test result
The recorded outcome of a defined test.

review a test result

test environment
The conditions and setup in which a test is performed.

identify the test environment

test data
The inputs used in a defined test.

specify the test data

expected result
The outcome required by the applicable test or criterion.

compare with the expected result

actual result
The outcome observed when the defined test is performed.

record the actual result

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

statement of work STATEMENT OF WORK

refer to the statement of work

Keep the meaning precise: The agreed description of the vendor's work and deliverables, commonly SOW.

requirements matrix REQUIREMENTS MATRIX

review the requirements matrix

Keep the meaning precise: A table linking requirements to identifiers, status, or supporting information.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

defect

A departure from a specified requirement or expected behavior.

log a verified defect

nonconformance

Failure to meet an applicable specified requirement.

document a nonconformance

punch list

A list of remaining items to address before a defined completion point.

maintain a punch list

waiver

An authorized exception to a specified requirement under the governing rules.

request a waiver

conditional acceptance

Acceptance limited by explicit unresolved conditions under the relevant authority.

document conditional acceptance

formal acceptance

Recorded acceptance by the authorized party under the applicable process.

confirm formal acceptance

handover package

The documents, outputs, and evidence transferred to the receiving team.

complete the handover package

completion claim

A party's statement that its work is finished.

verify a completion claim

commercial consequence

An effect on contractual or financial obligations requiring the governing terms.

assess commercial consequences

contract owner

The person responsible for managing the relevant agreement.

consult the contract owner

acceptance record

The documented acceptance decision and its basis or conditions.

retain the acceptance record

evidence handoff

Transfer of identifiable supporting information to the reviewer.

agree the evidence handoff

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

actual result ACTUAL RESULT

record the actual result

Keep the meaning precise: The outcome observed when the defined test is performed.

conditional acceptance CONDITIONAL ACCEPTANCE

document conditional acceptance

Keep the meaning precise: Acceptance limited by explicit unresolved conditions under the relevant authority.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the claim

I understand that your team considers development complete.

State the evidence position

We can verify four of the six agreed criteria.

Name the gaps

Evidence for C5 and C6 is missing from the handover package.

Avoid a false failure

Missing evidence does not itself establish a failed function.

Keep scope stable

We are asking for proof against existing criteria, not adding requirements.

Request traceability

Link each result to its criterion identifier and tested version.

Clarify the test context

Identify the environment, inputs, expected result, and actual result.

Separate the statuses

Delivered is not the same as formally accepted.

Keep the authority visible

I cannot waive these criteria on my own.

Avoid implied acceptance

A demonstration invitation is not an acceptance record.

Qualify conditional acceptance

Any conditional acceptance needs proper authority and explicit conditions.

Set the evidence deadline

Confirm when the missing evidence will be available for review.

Avoid premature closure

Keep the two criteria open until the evidence is assessed.

Handle terms correctly

Refer payment consequences to the contract owner and governing agreement.

Confirm the handoff

Name the sender, reviewer, file location, and next checkpoint.

Close with the actual state

Four verified, two awaiting evidence, acceptance not yet recorded.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Avoid a false failure
Useful wording: Missing evidence does not itself establish a failed function.

Purpose: Keep scope stable
Useful wording: We are asking for proof against existing criteria, not adding requirements.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which response preserves both accuracy and scope?

A. Please supply evidence for the existing C5 and C6 criteria; we are not adding new requirements.

B. Both functions are proven failures because evidence is missing.

C. Every function is accepted because the vendor is confident.

D. We can add unrelated requirements without a change discussion.

2. A C5 screenshot comes from an earlier build. What is the appropriate response?

A. Check its applicability and traceability to the delivered version before treating C5 as demonstrated.

B. Mark C5 failed solely because the screenshot is older.

C. Mark C5 accepted because any export screenshot proves every version.

D. Delete the version field so the package appears consistent.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The person or body empowered to accept the deliverable. Which term fits?

A. punch list

B. commercial consequence

C. acceptance authority

D. test environment

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted". Marta: "Understood. I was worried you had added requirements after delivery. Can we point the test lead back to the original acceptance criteria?" Leo: [missing response] Marta: "I found an export screenshot, but it is from an earlier build. Would sending it let you close C5 on the delivered version?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Confirmed. The acceptance record must capture the eventual authorized decision and its basis. Today we have agreed an evidence review, not acceptance of the deliverable.

B. Not without establishing its relevance. The requirements matrix must link the criterion to the tested version and supporting result, so the reviewer can assess applicability.

C. Yes, use the existing statement of work and the agreed C5 and C6 identifiers. I am requesting support for those requirements, not a new feature.

D. I will receive that evidence handoff and check the package at 14:30. That is a review checkpoint, not a promise that the criteria will pass.

Answers and explanations, page 141

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Four of six criteria have verified evidence. C5 and C6 are unverified in this record, not automatically failed or waived. A vendor completion claim and formal client acceptance are different statuses; neither substitutes for the other.

E Conversation

Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted

Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

waiver / conditional acceptance / requirements matrix / actual result / acceptance record / statement of work / contract owner / evidence handoff / completion claim / evidence gap

01 **Marta:** Our delivery tracker says complete, but your sheet still has two open criteria. Is this a disagreement about the work or about the handover evidence?

02 **Leo:** It is a difference between your [1] _____ and our acceptance status. Four of six criteria have verified support; C5 and C6 do not.

03 **Marta:** C5 is audit-log export and C6 is role-based access. I need to tell my team whether you found a failure or simply lack the results.

04 **Leo:** I am reporting an [2] _____. We have not demonstrated those two criteria in this record; that is not the same as proving either function failed.

05 **Marta:** Understood. I was worried you had added requirements after delivery. Can we point the test lead back to the original acceptance criteria?

06 **Leo:** Yes, use the existing [3] _____ and the agreed C5 and C6 identifiers. I am requesting support for those requirements, not a new feature.

07 **Marta:** I found an export screenshot, but it is from an earlier build. Would sending it let you close C5 on the delivered version?

08 **Leo:** Not without establishing its relevance. The [4] _____ must link the criterion to the tested version and supporting result, so the reviewer can assess applicability.

09 **Marta:** I will ask for the setup, input data, and expected behavior as well. A screenshot labeled passed does not show what the test actually checked.

10 **Leo:** Include the [5] _____ beside the expected result. For C6, make the tested role and relevant access behavior traceable to the agreed criterion.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Marta:** If the evidence is not ready today, could you remove those two criteria from the sheet so our delivery record can close?

12 **Leo:** I cannot grant that [6] _____ alone. Removing an agreed criterion is not a clerical correction; it needs the appropriate authority under the governing arrangement.

13 **Marta:** Could we request acceptance subject to later evidence? I am asking whether that is an option, not saying you have already accepted it.

14 **Leo:** Any [7] _____ needs an authorized decision and explicit conditions. We have no such decision recorded, so the current acceptance status remains open.

15 **Marta:** I will send the evidence package or an itemized gap update by 14:00. Can you confirm who receives it and when you will check what arrived?

16 **Leo:** I will receive that [8] _____ and check the package at 14:30. That is a review checkpoint, not a promise that the criteria will pass.

17 **Marta:** Our commercial team also asked whether they can invoice. I will not treat your agreement to review the package as a payment decision.

18 **Leo:** Refer invoicing to the [9] _____ and the agreement. These facts do not establish the payment consequence, and I cannot invent it from a status label.

19 **Marta:** I will tell our team: four criteria verified, C5 and C6 awaiting evidence, package or gap update at 14:00, client check at 14:30. No waiver is recorded.

20 **Leo:** Confirmed. The [10] _____ must capture the eventual authorized decision and its basis. Today we have agreed an evidence review, not acceptance of the deliverable.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. completion claim / **2.** evidence gap / **3.** statement of work / **4.** requirements matrix / **5.** actual result / **6.** waiver / **7.** conditional acceptance / **8.** evidence handoff / **9.** contract owner / **10.** acceptance record

Why these answers fit, page 142

F Check accuracy and scope

Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted

Return to the case

Vendor lead Marta says a workflow deliverable is complete. Client acceptance lead Leo can verify four of six agreed criteria, but finds no evidence for C5, audit-log export, or C6, role-based access behavior. The missing evidence does not itself prove those functions fail. No acceptance or waiver is recorded, and Leo cannot waive criteria alone. Contractual payment consequences have not been assessed. Leo and Marta must agree the evidence handoff without adding new scope or treating the delivery claim as acceptance.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which acceptance status is supported now?

A. No acceptance or waiver is recorded.
B. Unconditional formal acceptance is complete.
C. C5 and C6 have been waived by silence.
D. Leo has unlimited unilateral waiver authority.

2. What should be said about payment consequences?

A. They need assessment against the agreement by the appropriate owner.
B. Missing evidence automatically cancels every payment in all contracts.
C. A completion claim proves immediate payment under every agreement.
D. The project team may invent a new commercial term.

Answers and explanations, page 144

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20. Read the 14:00 package update and 14:30 review without converting either into acceptance.

Be firm about evidence without escalating the tone

A vendor can mean development complete while the client means accepted against the agreed criteria. State the missing evidence and identifiers precisely. This keeps the discussion focused on the original agreement instead of implying new requirements, accusing someone of failure without proof, or approving an incomplete record.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Unverified does not mean failed

Five criteria are agreed. Evidence supports four; the fifth has not been reviewed because its result is missing. No waiver or acceptance is recorded.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

recorded / failure / evidence / unverified

01 **Client:** Four criteria have supporting [1] _____.

02 **Vendor:** The fifth remains [2] _____.

03 **Client:** That does not itself prove a [3] _____.

04 **Vendor:** No acceptance has been [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. evidence / **2.** unverified / **3.** failure / **4.** recorded

Why these answers fit, page 144

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted". Marta: "Could we request acceptance subject to later evidence? I am asking whether that is an option, not saying you have already accepted it." Leo: [missing response] Marta: "I will send the evidence package or an itemized gap update by 14:00. Can you confirm who receives it and when you will check what arrived?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. It is a difference between your completion claim and our acceptance status. Four of six criteria have verified support; C5 and C6 do not.

B. I cannot grant that waiver alone. Removing an agreed criterion is not a clerical correction; it needs the appropriate authority under the governing arrangement.

C. Any conditional acceptance needs an authorized decision and explicit conditions. We have no such decision recorded, so the current acceptance status remains open.

D. Include the actual result beside the expected result. For C6, make the tested role and relevant access behavior traceable to the agreed criterion.

Answers and explanations, page 145

A Read the situation

LESSON 08 / POST-IMPLEMENTATION REVIEW

Convert a vague lesson into a specific process change with an owner, deadline, adoption check, and separate effectiveness review.

> **Turn communication was poor into a testable action**
>
> Review facilitator Hana and project-office lead Sanjay examine five scope handoffs from a completed project. Three lack recorded recipient acknowledgment before work began, and two tasks were reworked using an older specification. The notes repeatedly say communication was poor but contain no improvement action. The record does not prove a single cause. Sanjay proposes a revised handoff record by October 10 and a check of the next five handoffs. No pilot result is available yet.

People: Hana, Review facilitator; Sanjay, Project-office lead.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. How many reviewed handoffs lacked recorded acknowledgment before work?

A. All five
B. Two of ten
C. None
D. Three of five

2. What is established about the rework?

A. Two tasks used an older specification and were reworked.
B. All rework was proven to have a single cause.
C. The pilot eliminated every future error.
D. No specification version was ever involved.

3. What is the status of the proposed improvement?

A. Proposed, with no pilot result yet
B. Already proven effective over many projects
C. Fully adopted in the next five handoffs
D. A completed organization-wide policy audit

Answers and explanations, page 146

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

post-implementation review

An assessment after delivery of results, process, and lessons.

conduct a post-implementation review

after-action review

A structured discussion of what happened and what to improve.

facilitate an after-action review

lessons log

A record of learning from project experience.

maintain the lessons log

actionable lesson

Learning translated into a specific usable change.

formulate an actionable lesson

contributing factor

A condition that may have helped produce an outcome.

investigate a contributing factor

root-cause hypothesis

A proposed explanation for an underlying cause that needs evidence.

test a root-cause hypothesis

causal claim

A statement that one factor produced an outcome.

qualify a causal claim

blameless review

A learning-focused review that avoids unsupported personal blame without removing accountability.

hold a blameless review

knowledge transfer

Passing usable information or experience to another team.

improve knowledge transfer

improvement backlog

A prioritized list of changes intended to improve future work.

maintain an improvement backlog

corrective action

An action addressing a detected problem or its causes under the stated process.

assign a corrective action

preventive action

An action intended to reduce the chance of a future problem.

define a preventive action

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

post-implementation review POST-IMPLEMENTATION REVIEW

conduct a post-implementation review

Keep the meaning precise: An assessment after delivery of results, process, and lessons.

root-cause hypothesis ROOT-CAUSE HYPOTHESIS

test a root-cause hypothesis

Keep the meaning precise: A proposed explanation for an underlying cause that needs evidence.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

process owner

The person accountable for a defined working process.

identify the process owner

adoption check

A check that the intended process is actually being used.

perform an adoption check

process measure

An indicator of how work is performed.

define a process measure

baseline value

The reference measurement before the assessed change.

establish the baseline value

sample size

The number of observations in an assessment.

state the sample size

recipient acknowledgment

Confirmation from the receiving person that the specified handoff was received.

obtain recipient acknowledgment

due date

The agreed date by which a task should be completed.

set the due date

effectiveness review

An assessment of whether the change achieves its intended effect.

conduct an effectiveness review

outcome measure

An indicator of the result produced by the work.

distinguish an outcome measure

comparison window

The defined period or cases used for comparison.

specify the comparison window

version reference

The identifier of the document or specification used.

confirm the version reference

closure criterion

The condition required to mark an improvement action complete.

define the closure criterion

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

preventive action PREVENTIVE ACTION

define a preventive action

Keep the meaning precise: An action intended to reduce the chance of a future problem.

process measure PROCESS MEASURE

define a process measure

Keep the meaning precise: An indicator of how work is performed.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Replace the vague label

Three of five handoffs lacked recorded acknowledgment before work began.

State the linked observation

Two tasks were reworked using an older specification.

Limit the causal claim

The record does not establish one exclusive cause.

Name a concrete change

Add the scope identifier, version, owner, and recipient acknowledgment to the handoff record.

Assign the owner

Sanjay will prepare the revised record by October 10.

Define the pilot

Check the next five scope handoffs.

State the process target

Each of the five should have the required record before work starts.

Separate implementation

Publishing the template does not show that teams use it.

Check adoption

Review the actual handoff records, not just training attendance.

Measure the outcome separately

Track version-related rework on a stated comparison basis.

Keep the sample visible

Five cases are a small review sample, not universal proof.

Avoid percentage confusion

Moving from 40% to 80% is a 40-percentage-point increase.

Preserve incomplete status

Four of five would show improvement but miss the five-of-five target.

Plan the effectiveness review

Set who will check whether the change reduces the intended problem.

Close with evidence

Mark the action complete only against its defined closure criterion.

Transfer the learning

Put the tested change where the next project will actually use it.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Name a concrete change
Useful wording: Add the scope identifier, version, owner, and recipient acknowledgment to the handoff record.

Purpose: Assign the owner
Useful wording: Sanjay will prepare the revised record by October 10.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which action is most specific?

A. All teams should try harder without a review date.

B. The same vague lesson should be copied into every future report.

C. Sanjay revises the handoff record by October 10 and checks required fields in the next five handoffs.

D. Everyone should communicate better somehow.

2. Why does a published template not prove effectiveness?

A. A template makes outcome measurement impossible.

B. Publication proves a single root cause retrospectively.

C. Existence, use, and effect are different questions.

D. Every published document automatically prevents mistakes.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Learning translated into a specific usable change. Which term fits?

A. actionable lesson

B. sample size

C. adoption check

D. knowledge transfer

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Turn communication was poor into a testable action". Hana: "Let us define a change that addresses the gap without pretending the analysis is finished. What should the handoff record contain that it does not reliably show now?" Sanjay: [missing response] Hana: "Who will produce the revised record, and by when? A lesson saying someone should improve the template may disappear as soon as the project closes." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Run an adoption check on the next five scope handoffs. Check the required fields and acknowledgment before work starts, rather than counting how many people attended a briefing.

B. State the sample size whenever reporting the result. Keep other possible influences visible instead of treating a before-and-after difference as proof that our change was the only cause.

C. Add the scope identifier, version reference, responsible owner, and recipient acknowledgment before work starts. That makes the transferred instruction identifiable rather than leaving the receiver to infer which document applies.

D. I will be the process owner and prepare the revision by October tenth. Record that commitment with the deliverable, not simply assign it to the project office.

Answers and explanations, page 146

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Two of five handoffs had recorded acknowledgment, a 40% baseline on that process measure. A future four of five would be 80%, an increase of 40 percentage points. It would still miss a five-of-five target and would not alone prove less rework.

E Conversation

Turn communication was poor into a testable action

Turn communication was poor into a testable action

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

closure criterion / process measure / adoption check / sample size / recipient acknowledgment / version reference / causal claim / effectiveness review / baseline value / process owner

01 **Hana:** The review notes say communication was poor three times, but I cannot find an action that would change the next project. What did the records actually show?

02 **Sanjay:** Three of five handoffs lacked recorded [1] _____ before work started. We also found two tasks that used an older specification and had to be reworked.

03 **Hana:** Those are more useful observations than the broad label. Do they prove that the missing acknowledgment was the sole cause of the rework?

04 **Sanjay:** No. That would be an unsupported [2] _____. The records suggest a process gap to investigate, but they do not exclude other contributing factors.

05 **Hana:** Let us define a change that addresses the gap without pretending the analysis is finished. What should the handoff record contain that it does not reliably show now?

06 **Sanjay:** Add the scope identifier, [3] _____, responsible owner, and recipient acknowledgment before work starts. That makes the transferred instruction identifiable rather than leaving the receiver to infer which document applies.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Hana:** Who will produce the revised record, and by when? A lesson saying someone should improve the template may disappear as soon as the project closes.

08 **Sanjay:** I will be the [4] _____ and prepare the revision by October tenth. Record that commitment with the deliverable, not simply assign it to the project office.

09 **Hana:** Once the template is published, who checks that people actually use it? I do not want the action closed while the next handoff still lacks an acknowledgment.

10 **Sanjay:** Run an [5] _____ on the next five scope handoffs. Check the required fields and acknowledgment before work starts, rather than counting how many people attended a briefing.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Turn communication was poor into a testable action

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Hana:** What is the comparison point? We need a clear measure so a later reviewer can tell whether the process changed.

12 **Sanjay:** The [6] _____ is two of five with recorded acknowledgment, or forty percent. The pilot target is five of five, with the sample and timing basis stated.

13 **Hana:** Suppose the pilot later shows four of five. That would be progress, but the target would still be unmet, and it would not tell us everything about rework.

14 **Sanjay:** Correct. The [7] _____ would be eighty percent. That is forty percentage points above baseline, not evidence that every intended outcome has been achieved.

15 **Hana:** Keep a separate check on version-related rework. A fully completed form will not tell us whether the team actually used the right specification.

16 **Sanjay:** Set an [8] _____ with a responsible reviewer and comparison window. Adoption matters, but the intended result needs its own evidence and a clear measurement basis.

17 **Hana:** Five cases is also a small sample. We can use it to spot a problem with the process, but not claim a universal result from a short pilot.

18 **Sanjay:** State the [9] _____ whenever reporting the result. Keep other possible influences visible instead of treating a before-and-after difference as proof that our change was the only cause.

19 **Hana:** That gives us an action, an owner, a deadline, and two different checks: whether the process is used and whether it helps. How should we close it?

20 **Sanjay:** Define the [10] _____ for each stage. We should not mark the entire lesson resolved merely because the template was published; the follow-up records must show what was implemented and what was actually learned.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. recipient acknowledgment / **2.** causal claim / **3.** version reference / **4.** process owner / **5.** adoption check / **6.** baseline value / **7.** process measure / **8.** effectiveness review / **9.** sample size / **10.** closure criterion

Why these answers fit, page 147

F Check accuracy and scope

Turn communication was poor into a testable action

Return to the case

Review facilitator Hana and project-office lead Sanjay examine five scope handoffs from a completed project. Three lack recorded recipient acknowledgment before work began, and two tasks were reworked using an older specification. The notes repeatedly say communication was poor but contain no improvement action. The record does not prove a single cause. Sanjay proposes a revised handoff record by October 10 and a check of the next five handoffs. No pilot result is available yet.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. A later pilot moves recorded acknowledgment from two of five to four of five. Which interpretation is accurate?

A. The rate rises from 40% to 80%, up 40 percentage points and 100% relatively, while missing the five-of-five target.

B. The rate rises by 40% relatively and therefore meets the full target.

C. The rate rises from 40% to 80%, proving version-related rework has halved.

D. Four of five is effectively 100% because the sample is small.

2. What does a small improved before-and-after result establish by itself?

A. A reason to remove the sample size from reporting

B. An observed difference in the measured cases, not proof of an exclusive cause

C. A universal guarantee for every future project

D. Proof that no other factor changed

Answers and explanations, page 149

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20. Separate publication, adoption, and effectiveness; do not report a pilot result for the main case.

A lesson needs somewhere to go

A review can sound candid while leaving the next project unchanged. Name the observed process gap and a concrete improvement, then distinguish whether people adopt the new process from whether it improves the outcome. Keep accountability without inventing a single culprit or a causal conclusion the record cannot support.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

A better rate, an unmet target

The baseline has recorded acknowledgment in three of six handoffs. A later pilot has five of six, against a six-of-six target. Rework outcomes have not yet been measured.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

unmet / five / fifty / measured

01 **Reviewer:** The baseline rate was [1] _____ percent.

02 **Owner:** The pilot has [2] _____ acknowledged handoffs out of six.

03 **Reviewer:** The six-of-six target remains [3] _____.

04 **Owner:** Rework effectiveness is not yet [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. fifty / **2.** five / **3.** unmet / **4.** measured

Why these answers fit, page 149

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Turn communication was poor into a testable action". Hana: "Suppose the pilot later shows four of five. That would be progress, but the target would still be unmet, and it would not tell us everything about rework." Sanjay: [missing response] Hana: "Keep a separate check on version-related rework. A fully completed form will not tell us whether the team actually used the right specification." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. The process measure would be eighty percent. That is forty percentage points above baseline, not evidence that every intended outcome has been achieved.

B. Three of five handoffs lacked recorded recipient acknowledgment before work started. We also found two tasks that used an older specification and had to be reworked.

C. Set an effectiveness review with a responsible reviewer and comparison window. Adoption matters, but the intended result needs its own evidence and a clear measurement basis.

D. No. That would be an unsupported causal claim. The records suggest a process gap to investigate, but they do not exclude other contributing factors.

Answers and explanations, page 150

Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery" and "Post-Implementation Review". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The arrangement for checking and deciding acceptance of outputs. Which term fits?

A. nonconformance
B. acceptance plan
C. completion claim
D. test result

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A learning-focused review that avoids unsupported personal blame without removing accountability. Which term fits?

A. blameless review
B. process owner
C. baseline value
D. post-implementation review

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened". James: "Who is responsible for obtaining the approval? A clear owner would help me understand where support is needed instead of sending a general chase to everyone." Sofia: [missing response] James: "I can help bring the decision to the right forum, but I cannot treat the urgency as permission to bypass the access approval itself." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. That is task-count completion, not eighty percent of all effort or readiness. The remaining tasks may differ in size, and one contains the input needed for rehearsal.
B. That is the appropriate executive ask. We need support securing a timely decision through the proper route, not an assurance that an unapproved input can be treated as available.
C. Identify the dependency owner and the authorized decision route. The report should say who is following up, what decision is required, and when the next status check will occur.
D. An exception report can make that concise. It should expose the access issue without forcing the sponsor to discover it inside a long list of activities that are already finished.

Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Turn communication was poor into a testable action". Hana: "Five cases is also a small sample. We can use it to spot a problem with the process, but not claim a universal result from a short pilot." Sanjay: [missing response] Hana: "That gives us an action, an owner, a deadline, and two different checks: whether the process is used and whether it helps. How should we close it?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will be the process owner and prepare the revision by October tenth. Record that commitment with the deliverable, not simply assign it to the project office.

B. The baseline value is two of five with recorded acknowledgment, or forty percent. The pilot target is five of five, with the sample and timing basis stated.

C. State the sample size whenever reporting the result. Keep other possible influences visible instead of treating a before-and-after difference as proof that our change was the only cause.

D. Run an adoption check on the next five scope handoffs. Check the required fields and acknowledgment before work starts, rather than counting how many people attended a briefing.

Answers and explanations, page 160

Language for the next case

Spending less than planned is not necessarily good news

planned value

Planned value is the budget assigned to work scheduled by the reporting date, not the value of the work actually completed.

Ines: Not from those figures. The planned value is sixty thousand, but we have not completed all the work scheduled for this point.

earned value

Earned value is the budgeted value of work actually performed under the agreed measurement method, here $45,000.

Ines: The earned value is forty-five thousand. That is the budgeted value of the completed work, not sales revenue or the cash received.

cost variance

Cost variance is earned value minus actual cost: $45,000 minus $50,000 gives negative $5,000.

Ines: Exactly. The cost variance is negative five thousand: forty-five minus fifty. We have spent more than the earned value of the work achieved.

cost performance index

The cost performance index is earned value divided by actual cost; $45,000 divided by $50,000 equals 0.90.

Ines: The cost performance index is zero point nine. On this basis, each dollar of actual cost has earned ninety cents of budgeted work value.

schedule variance

The earned-value schedule variance is earned value minus planned value: $45,000 minus $60,000 equals negative $15,000 of budgeted work.

Ines: Yes. The schedule variance is negative fifteen thousand in budgeted-work terms. That is not fifteen thousand dollars of cash loss or fifteen days of delay.

estimate at completion

An estimate at completion forecasts total final cost using a justified method and assumptions; the three supplied current-period measures alone do not provide it.

Ines: Only with the appropriate remaining-work basis and assumptions. An estimate at completion is a forecast, not a number we should infer without the necessary inputs.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Spending less than planned is not necessarily good news

At one reporting date, a fictional project has planned value of $60,000, earned value of $45,000, and actual cost of $50,000, all on the same agreed basis. A sponsor calls the $10,000 difference between planned value and actual cost a saving. The analyst must explain the supported measures. No final-cost or completion-date forecast is supplied.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

planned value / cost performance index / cost variance / schedule variance / estimate at completion / earned value

01 **Drew:** We planned sixty thousand dollars and spent fifty thousand. Can I tell the steering group we have saved ten thousand?

02 **Ines:** Not from those figures. The [1] _____ is sixty thousand, but we have not completed all the work scheduled for this point.

03 **Drew:** What number shows the work we have actually achieved on the budget basis? I do not want to confuse invoices with progress.

04 **Ines:** The [2] _____ is forty-five thousand. That is the budgeted value of the completed work, not sales revenue or the cash received.

05 **Drew:** Then fifty thousand is the cost of achieving forty-five thousand of budgeted work. That is different from being ten thousand under budget.

06 **Ines:** Exactly. The [3] _____ is negative five thousand: forty-five minus fifty. We have spent more than the earned value of the work achieved.

Conversation / continued

07 **Drew:** The report also asks for the cost index. Could you explain the ratio in language the steering group can follow?

08 **Ines:** The [4] _____ is zero point nine. On this basis, each dollar of actual cost has earned ninety cents of budgeted work value.

09 **Drew:** And how far behind the planned work are we? I assume that needs the sixty-thousand figure rather than actual cost.

10 **Ines:** Yes. The [5] _____ is negative fifteen thousand in budgeted-work terms. That is not fifteen thousand dollars of cash loss or fifteen days of delay.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Spending less than planned is not necessarily good news

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Drew:** The schedule index would therefore be forty-five divided by sixty, or zero point seven five. Does that mean the finish date is twenty-five percent late?

12 **Ines:** No. It describes earned value relative to planned value at this point. The completion date needs the remaining schedule and its dependencies, not that direct conversion.

13 **Drew:** Could we use the cost index to produce a final-cost forecast for the board?

14 **Ines:** Only with the appropriate remaining-work basis and assumptions. An [6] _____ is a forecast, not a number we should infer without the necessary inputs.

15 **Drew:** I will replace savings with the actual position: less work achieved than scheduled, and a negative cost variance on that achieved work.

16 **Ines:** Good. Keep the common reporting date and measurement basis visible so the comparison does not mix this month's costs with last month's progress.

17 **Drew:** What do you need from the delivery team before we discuss recovery? I would rather ask for specific evidence than demand a better index.

18 **Ines:** The remaining work, its current estimate, dependencies, and proposed actions. We also need to understand the causes of the variance before assigning a remedy.

19 **Drew:** Then the steering group gets the supported measures today and a separately identified forecast review. We will not announce a saving or a new finish date.

20 **Ines:** Exactly. These measures identify questions requiring attention; they do not replace the work of explaining the performance and planning what happens next.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. planned value / **2.** earned value / **3.** cost variance / **4.** cost performance index / **5.** schedule variance / **6.** estimate at completion

Why these answers fit, page 163

A positive cash difference hides a cost overrun

On a consistent basis, planned value is $20,000, earned value is $15,000, and actual cost is $18,000.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

cost / variance / value / delay

01 **Sponsor:** Cost variance compares earned value with actual [1] _____.

02 **Analyst:** Fifteen thousand minus eighteen thousand gives a negative three-thousand-dollar [2] _____.

03 **Sponsor:** The schedule comparison uses the twenty-thousand-dollar planned [3] _____.

04 **Analyst:** A monetary schedule variance is not a calendar-day [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. cost / **2.** variance / **3.** value / **4.** delay

Why these answers fit, page 163

Keep the distinction audible

Explain earned-value measures without confusing budget performance, cash, and calendar delay.

Language for the next case

A new request arrives halfway through the sprint

Sprint Goal

The Sprint Goal is the sprint's single objective; here it concerns finding an overdue case and its owner, not an unrelated visual request.

Bo: Yes. Our Sprint Goal is overdue-case lookup with the owner visible. The color request does not help us meet that objective.

Sprint Backlog

The Sprint Backlog is the Developers' current plan for the Sprint Goal and selected work; it can be adapted as more is learned.

Bo: Agreed. The Sprint Backlog is a plan we adapt as we learn. We need to discuss the impact, not treat it as either untouchable or unlimited.

Definition of Done

The Definition of Done describes the required quality state of the Increment; dropping required checks to fit extra work would not satisfy it.

Bo: We can examine it together, but we must not compromise the Definition of Done. Removing required checks is not a legitimate way to make room.

Product Backlog

The Product Backlog is the ordered list of what is needed to improve the product; adding an item there does not promise delivery in the current sprint.

Alexis: Understood. I can place the color request in the Product Backlog for ordering and refinement if it does not fit this sprint.

Daily Scrum

The Daily Scrum is for the Developers to inspect progress toward the Sprint Goal and adapt their plan, not a manager's task-allocation meeting.

Bo: That is not its purpose. The Daily Scrum helps the Developers inspect progress toward the goal and adapt the plan. A short task list does not establish spare capacity.

Increment

An Increment must meet the Definition of Done to be usable; a demonstration of unfinished work does not make that work Done.

Bo: Yes. And the Increment we describe as usable must meet our quality definition. A convincing demonstration is not enough if required work is incomplete.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

A new request arrives halfway through the sprint

A Scrum team is halfway through a sprint whose goal is to let support agents find an overdue case and see its owner. An unrelated dashboard color request arrives from a senior stakeholder. The selected work already fills the Developers' current capacity forecast. The Product Owner and a Developer discuss options; no change has been made.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

Sprint Backlog / Daily Scrum / Product Backlog / Definition of Done / Increment / Sprint Goal

01 **Alexis:** A senior stakeholder wants the dashboard colors changed this week. Before I respond, can we look at what that would do to our current plan?

02 **Bo:** Yes. Our [1] _____ is overdue-case lookup with the owner visible. The color request does not help us meet that objective.

03 **Alexis:** I do not want to add it just because the requester is senior. At the same time, I should not tell them the plan can never change.

04 **Bo:** Agreed. The [2] _____ is a plan we adapt as we learn. We need to discuss the impact, not treat it as either untouchable or unlimited.

05 **Alexis:** The original selection uses the capacity you forecast. Would the color change displace work needed for the case lookup?

06 **Bo:** On our present assessment, yes. It also needs the usual checks. It is not free work simply because the visible change looks small.

Conversation / continued

07 **Alexis:** Could we reduce a nonessential part of the selected work while still meeting the goal? I would like to understand that option before saying no.

08 **Bo:** We can examine it together, but we must not compromise the [3] _____. Removing required checks is not a legitimate way to make room.

09 **Alexis:** Understood. I can place the color request in the [4] _____ for ordering and refinement if it does not fit this sprint.

10 **Bo:** That lets us assess its value and detail without quietly changing today's work. Please tell the stakeholder that recording the request is not a delivery promise.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A new request arrives halfway through the sprint

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Alexis:** What about the Daily Scrum? Could I use tomorrow's meeting to assign the new request to someone with a lighter-looking task list?

12 **Bo:** That is not its purpose. The [5] _____ helps the Developers inspect progress toward the goal and adapt the plan. A short task list does not establish spare capacity.

13 **Alexis:** I will bring the value and urgency question to our planning discussion instead. Is there any new information threatening the goal itself?

14 **Bo:** The test data is late, and we are arranging an alternative dataset through the approved route. I will make that obstacle visible rather than hide it behind a busy board.

15 **Alexis:** Then the immediate priority is resolving that obstacle. When we speak to the stakeholder, I can explain why the lookup outcome remains our focus.

16 **Bo:** Yes. And the [6] _____ we describe as usable must meet our quality definition. A convincing demonstration is not enough if required work is incomplete.

17 **Alexis:** I will acknowledge the color request, record it, and explain that delivery this week is not agreed. We can revisit its order with the other product needs.

18 **Bo:** I will update the current plan and the data dependency with the Developers. Any scope negotiation needs to preserve the goal, not rewrite it after the fact.

19 **Alexis:** That gives us a clear response without claiming Scrum means never changing anything or accepting every urgent-looking request.

20 **Bo:** Exactly. We can adapt the work intelligently while keeping the objective and the quality expectation clear.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. Sprint Goal / **2.** Sprint Backlog / **3.** Definition of Done / **4.** Product Backlog / **5.** Daily Scrum / **6.** Increment

Why these answers fit, page 165

A demonstration is mistaken for Done work

A feature works in a demonstration, but required checks in the team's Definition of Done are incomplete.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

plan / request / Done / Goal

01 **Product Owner:** The demonstration does not establish that the item is [1] _____.

02 **Developer:** Keep the unfinished checks visible in the current [2] _____.

03 **Product Owner:** Do not drop required quality work to accept an extra [3] _____.

04 **Developer:** Explain progress against the agreed Sprint [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. Done / **2.** plan / **3.** request / **4.** Goal

Why these answers fit, page 165

Keep the distinction audible

Negotiate a delivery plan around a sprint goal without treating selected work as immutable or quality as optional.

Language for the next case

The project is finishing, but who supports the service on Monday?

operational acceptance

Operational acceptance establishes that the agreed conditions for taking responsibility are met; completing training does not settle every support requirement.

Felix: Not yet. The operational acceptance checklist still has open items. We have no confirmed out-of-hours contact, and my team cannot access the monitoring view.

support model

The support model defines who handles incidents, how they are routed, and when coverage is available for the service.

Felix: Start with the support model. Who receives the first call, who investigates, and who can make a service decision when the project team is unavailable?

escalation matrix

The escalation matrix identifies the roles and routes for unresolved or serious issues; it needs actual owners and coverage rather than unconfirmed names.

Felix: Then the escalation matrix is incomplete. A name on a slide does not establish that someone has accepted the duty or can be reached.

runbook

A runbook gives the approved operational procedures and relevant response information for the service; training attendance alone does not provide that resource.

Felix: Working access, a usable runbook, and confirmation that the team can find the required information. We should check those with the people who will use them.

defect ownership

Defect ownership assigns responsibility for tracking and resolving each defect after transition; an open list without owners leaves the work unassigned.

Felix: Exactly. I need the user impact, current workaround where approved, and defect ownership. The word minor does not tell my team what to do.

hypercare

Hypercare is a defined period of enhanced support after a change; its label does not establish staffing, responsibilities, or completion conditions.

Felix: It could help, but hypercare needs agreed staffing, scope, and exit conditions. At present it is an unstaffed proposal, not confirmed cover.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

The project is finishing, but who supports the service on Monday?

A project plans to hand a new internal service to operations on Friday. Training is complete, but the out-of-hours contact, access to monitoring, and ownership of three open defects are unresolved. A two-week enhanced-support period is proposed, not yet staffed or agreed. The project lead meets the service owner.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

defect ownership / support model / runbook / operational acceptance / escalation matrix / hypercare

01 **Nadia:** Training is complete and the project closes on Friday. Are you comfortable taking the service from Monday, including anything that happens outside office hours?

02 **Felix:** Not yet. The [1] _____ checklist still has open items. We have no confirmed out-of-hours contact, and my team cannot access the monitoring view.

03 **Nadia:** I saw the training completion note and assumed the handover was ready. Let us go through the remaining conditions instead of relying on that one milestone.

04 **Felix:** Start with the [2] _____. Who receives the first call, who investigates, and who can make a service decision when the project team is unavailable?

05 **Nadia:** The proposal names the service desk for first contact and our technical team for escalation, but their coverage has not been confirmed.

06 **Felix:** Then the [3] _____ is incomplete. A name on a slide does not establish that someone has accepted the duty or can be reached.

Conversation / continued

07 **Nadia:** I will resolve that with the responsible managers. What do you need on the monitoring side before accepting the service?

08 **Felix:** Working access, a usable [4] _____, and confirmation that the team can find the required information. We should check those with the people who will use them.

09 **Nadia:** There are also three open defects. The project report calls them minor, but we should describe their effect and the agreed handling individually.

10 **Felix:** Exactly. I need the user impact, current workaround where approved, and [5] _____. The word minor does not tell my team what to do.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The project is finishing, but who supports the service on Monday?

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Nadia:** Would the proposed two-week hypercare period cover the remaining questions? That was intended to give operations extra support after the transition.

12 **Felix:** It could help, but [6] _____ needs agreed staffing, scope, and exit conditions. At present it is an unstaffed proposal, not confirmed cover.

13 **Nadia:** We should not assume project closure automatically closes those defects or ends every responsibility. I will keep the unresolved work in the transition record.

14 **Felix:** Thank you. We also need to distinguish service acceptance from any commercial or contractual closeout. My decision should not imply authority over those separate matters.

15 **Nadia:** I will bring the contact coverage, monitoring access, defect assignments, and enhanced-support proposal to the readiness review. Is anything else missing from the decision package?

16 **Felix:** Include the acceptance criteria and evidence for each. If a condition remains open, state its consequence and who can decide the appropriate response.

17 **Nadia:** Then Friday is a planned decision point, not an automatic transfer because the calendar says the project should end.

18 **Felix:** Correct. I can commit to reviewing a complete package; I cannot commit to accepting unknown support gaps in advance.

19 **Nadia:** I will update the project board with that distinction and arrange the right people for the review, including the proposed support owners.

20 **Felix:** That gives us a real handover conversation. Operations needs a service it can support, not only a completed training attendance sheet.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. operational acceptance / **2.** support model / **3.** escalation matrix / **4.** runbook / **5.** defect ownership / **6.** hypercare

Why these answers fit, page 167

An enhanced-support period has no assigned team

A transition plan promises ten days of enhanced support, but no staff, contact route, or exit conditions have been agreed.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

route / review / staffed / support

01 **Service owner:** The support period is proposed, not yet [1] _____.

02 **Project lead:** Confirm responsibilities and the incident contact [2] _____.

03 **Service owner:** Define the conditions for ending enhanced [3] _____.

04 **Project lead:** Keep unresolved conditions visible at the acceptance [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. staffed / **2.** route / **3.** support / **4.** review

Why these answers fit, page 167

> **Keep the distinction audible**
>
> Negotiate an operational handover with clear ownership, open defects, and support boundaries.

01 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Who are the proposed first-release users?

C. Operations leads doing weekly queue triage

The meeting proposal identifies operations leads and their weekly triage task.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A2. Which feature is proposed as excluded?

A. Automated work allocation

The proposed boundary explicitly excludes automated allocation while retaining visibility and export.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A3. What does four weeks represent now?

B. A requested target, not a supported delivery commitment

The request precedes confirmed access, acceptance criteria, and an approved scope baseline.

Return to the exercise, page 4

D / Response choices

D1. Which scope statement best matches the supplied proposal?

D. Overdue-item visibility and export for weekly operations triage, excluding automated allocation

This wording identifies the intended users, work purpose, included functions, and explicit exclusion.

Return to the exercise, page 8

D2. What can Elena responsibly say about four weeks?

D. It is the target; access, acceptance, and feasibility still need confirmation.

The missing planning inputs prevent the requested date from becoming a supported commitment.

Return to the exercise, page 8

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The justification for the proposed investment and expected value. Which term fits?

A. business case

A Correct. business case: The justification for the proposed investment and expected value. The usual combination is "review the business case".

B Not here. requirement: A defined need or condition the solution must satisfy. The usual combination is "clarify the requirement".

C Not here. work package: A defined unit of work that can be assigned and managed. The usual combination is "specify a work package".

D Not here. scope statement: A description of the work and boundaries included in the project. The usual combination is "refine the scope statement".

Return to the exercise, page 8

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A dashboard is not yet a defined project". Greg: "I do not need automated work allocation in the first version. That might become useful later, but visibility and an export are the immediate request." Elena: [missing response] Greg: "I want the leads to make better queue decisions, not just get another screen. How do we keep that outcome distinct from what the team is building?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will make that out of scope for the proposed first release. A possible future capability should not quietly enter the current delivery commitment.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Greg says: "I need to check my assumption about the data. The records exist, but the data team has not confirmed that this project can access them." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Elena's response in turn 6. It connects Greg's preceding point with Greg's follow-up. Out of scope identifies automated allocation as excluded from the proposed first release.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Greg says: "We should probably define what shows that the view is adequate. Otherwise I might approve a demonstration and discover later that it cannot support the weekly meeting." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Greg says: "I am comfortable reviewing a clearer definition first. It should show the user, the two requested capabilities, the exclusion, and the open access question." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 8

E / Conversation

1. business need

Turn 2. The business need explains the problem the dashboard addresses rather than assuming its form defines its purpose.

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. end user

Turn 4. The end user is the operations lead using the proposed dashboard for weekly triage.

3. out of scope

Turn 6. Out of scope identifies automated allocation as excluded from the proposed first release.

4. deliverable

Turn 8. The deliverable is the dashboard output, distinct from the operational result achieved by using it.

5. acceptance criterion

Turn 10. An acceptance criterion makes adequacy checkable instead of relying on a favorable demonstration impression.

6. assumption

Turn 12. The assumption is the unverified planning premise that the source data will be available.

7. constraint

Turn 14. The requested timing is a planning limit to assess, not evidence that the proposed work is feasible within it.

8. scope statement

Turn 16. The scope statement describes the proposed work and boundaries before they become an approved reference.

9. requirements traceability

Turn 18. Requirements traceability connects each requirement and its evidence to the underlying need and agreed work.

10. scope approval

Turn 20. Scope approval authorizes the defined boundaries; the current discussion prepares that decision rather than pretending it occurred.

Return to the conversation, page 10

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which is an outcome rather than merely an output?

C. Operations leads make better-supported queue-priority decisions.

An outcome concerns changed use or behavior enabled by the delivered outputs.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F2. A sponsor likes the demonstration but the acceptance criteria and authority remain unconfirmed. Which status is justified?

B. Favorable feedback received; formal acceptance is not established.

A favorable reaction is useful feedback, but it does not supply the missing acceptance basis, decision authority, or schedule evidence.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F / Guided speaking

1. export

Sponsor: The included capability is a weekly export.

Turn 1. The supplied proposal specifically includes an export for the first release.

2. excluded

Manager: Automated allocation is excluded.

Turn 2. The proposed boundary explicitly leaves automated allocation outside this release.

3. unconfirmed

Sponsor: Data access remains unconfirmed.

Turn 3. The briefing does not establish that the source data is available.

4. commitment

Manager: The target is not an approved commitment.

Turn 4. The requested date has not received approval as a delivery commitment.

Return to the conversation, page 13

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A dashboard is not yet a defined project". Greg: "Then four weeks may still be possible, but I should not tell other departments it is an approved delivery promise simply because I prefer that date." Elena: [missing response] Greg: "I am comfortable reviewing a clearer definition first. It should show the user, the two requested capabilities, the exclusion, and the open access question." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Correct. The constraint needs assessment alongside the work and dependencies. If the date is fixed, we need a supported scope and delivery plan within that limit.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Greg says: "We should keep the requirements connected to the reason for the project. Otherwise an attractive feature may distract us from the weekly triage need." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Greg says: "I want the leads to make better queue decisions, not just get another screen. How do we keep that outcome distinct from what the team is building?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Elena's response in turn 14. It connects Greg's preceding point with Greg's follow-up. The requested timing is a planning limit to assess, not evidence that the proposed work is feasible within it.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Greg says: "We should probably define what shows that the view is adequate. Otherwise I might approve a demonstration and discover later that it cannot support the weekly meeting." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 13

02 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. How late is the testing finish forecast?

C. Three working days

The forecast moves from the end of working day 5 to the end of working day 8.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A2. When did the baseline release chain finish?

A. End of day 8

Testing ended on day 5, rehearsal used days 6 and 7, and approval used day 8.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A3. What is the forecast release finish with unchanged logic and durations?

A. End of day 11

Testing ends on day 8, rehearsal uses days 9 and 10, and approval uses day 11.

Return to the exercise, page 14

D / Response choices

D1. Which statement correctly reports the unchanged forecast?

D. Release moves from end of day 8 to end of day 11, a three-working-day delay.

The sequential two-day rehearsal and one-day approval preserve the three-day shift in the controlling chain.

Return to the exercise, page 18

D2. Another path has four days of float. Does that automatically absorb this chain's three-day slip?

A. No; float on another path does not change this controlling chain's zero-buffer logic.

Float belongs to activities and their schedule relationships. Unrelated flexibility does not remove this chain's predecessor requirements or create recovery.

Return to the exercise, page 18

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A day counted as available work under the stated calendar. Which term fits?

A. working day

A Correct. working day: A day counted as available work under the stated calendar. The usual combination is "state the delay in working days".

B Not here. milestone: A defined project event used to track an important point. The usual combination is "confirm the release milestone".

C Not here. finish-to-start dependency: A link requiring the predecessor to finish before the successor starts. The usual combination is "check a finish-to-start dependency".

D Not here. resource leveling: Adjusting timing to resolve resource limits or conflicts. The usual combination is "apply resource leveling".

Return to the exercise, page 18

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "One late task can move the release". Anika: "If testing now finishes at the end of day eight, could rehearsal still start that morning? Both dates would say day eight on the chart." Luis: [missing response] Anika: "I nearly added three days for testing and another three for each successor. That would have made the delay nine days, which looks wrong." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. No. The finish-to-start dependency requires completed testing. With no overlap or lag, rehearsal uses days nine and ten; approval follows on day eleven.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Anika says: "Let me reconstruct the original sequence first. Testing through day five, then two days of rehearsal, then one day for approval. Was release originally day eight?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Anika says: "Most of the project is on schedule, but testing has moved from day five to day eight. Can I leave the release milestone unchanged in the sponsor report?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Anika says: "Could adding testers shorten the remaining work? I can ask for an assessment, but some test steps may depend on the same environment." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Luis's response in turn 6. It connects Anika's preceding point with Anika's follow-up. A finish-to-start dependency prevents rehearsal from starting until testing has finished under the stated plan.

Return to the exercise, page 18

E / Conversation

1. critical path

Turn 2. The critical path is the stated controlling testing-rehearsal-approval chain, so independent on-time work does not remove its delay.

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. schedule baseline

Turn 4. The schedule baseline puts testing at day 5, rehearsal on days 6-7, and approval on day 8.

3. finish-to-start dependency

Turn 6. A finish-to-start dependency prevents rehearsal from starting until testing has finished under the stated plan.

4. downstream impact

Turn 8. The downstream impact is the three-day movement of the subsequent chain, not repeated addition of the same delay.

5. working calendar

Turn 10. The working calendar defines available workdays and must be consistent across the baseline and forecast calculation.

6. total float

Turn 12. Total float is schedule flexibility before the defined finish moves; this controlling chain is stated to have none.

7. crashing

Turn 14. Crashing adds resources or cost to shorten duration only where the activity can actually use them effectively.

8. fast-tracking

Turn 16. Fast-tracking overlaps previously sequential work and requires assessment of feasibility and additional risk.

9. schedule forecast

Turn 18. The schedule forecast is the current timing estimate; updating it does not silently authorize a new baseline.

10. forecast variance

Turn 20. Forecast variance is the difference between current forecast and the original reference, here three working days.

Return to the conversation, page 20

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which proposal is fast-tracking?

D. Overlap tasks previously planned in sequence, after assessing feasibility and risk

Fast-tracking changes sequencing through overlap and can introduce additional risk.

Return to the exercise, page 23

F2. A different task has four days of total float and slips three days with no other changes. What follows?

A. Its slip can be absorbed without moving the defined project finish.

The three-day movement is within the stated four-day allowance under that different schedule model.

Return to the exercise, page 23

F / Guided speaking

1. five

Planner: The original chain finished on day five.

Turn 1. Testing through day four followed by one review day finishes on day five.

2. seven

Lead: The forecast finish is now day seven.

Turn 2. Testing through day six followed by one review day finishes on day seven.

3. two

Planner: That is a two-working-day delay.

Turn 3. The finish moves from day five to day seven, a two-day difference.

4. approved

Lead: No recovery has been approved.

Turn 4. The briefing explicitly leaves every recovery option without authorization.

Return to the conversation, page 24

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "One late task can move the release". Anika: "Could adding testers shorten the remaining work? I can ask for an assessment, but some test steps may depend on the same environment." Luis: [missing response] Anika: "The other proposal starts some rehearsal before testing finishes. That sounds different from adding people and could require rehearsal to be repeated." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. That would be a crashing option if resources can actually shorten duration. Check the remaining work, constraints, cost, and coordination before promising recovery.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Anika says: "Let me reconstruct the original sequence first. Testing through day five, then two days of rehearsal, then one day for approval. Was release originally day eight?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Anika says: "Most of the project is on schedule, but testing has moved from day five to day eight. Can I leave the release milestone unchanged in the sponsor report?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Anika says: "If testing now finishes at the end of day eight, could rehearsal still start that morning? Both dates would say day eight on the chart." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Luis's response in turn 14. It connects Anika's preceding point with Anika's follow-up. Crashing adds resources or cost to shorten duration only where the activity can actually use them effectively.

Return to the exercise, page 24

03 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What has the supplier confirmed?

A. The October 12 commitment will be missed.

The confirmed fact is the original-date miss, while the later date remains only a possibility.

Return to the exercise, page 27

A2. What does October 15 represent?

D. The earliest possible date mentioned, not a commitment

The briefing explicitly qualifies October 15 as possible rather than committed.

Return to the exercise, page 27

A3. Why is the October 13 test exposed?

D. It requires the delivery that will miss October 12.

The supplied dependency connects the missed delivery to the planned test start.

Return to the exercise, page 27

D / Response choices

D1. Which opening is accurate now?

D. The October 12 miss is confirmed; the replacement date remains uncommitted.

The opening separates the established miss from continuing uncertainty about replacement timing.

Return to the exercise, page 31

D2. How should the original risk record be handled?

B. Update its status and link it to the current issue while preserving history.

Linked records preserve how the risk developed without leaving an obsolete event status in place.

Return to the exercise, page 31

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A record of identified risks, assessment, ownership, and responses. Which term fits?

D. risk register

A Not here. likelihood: The assessed chance of an uncertain event or condition. The usual combination is "reassess likelihood".

B Not here. contingency plan: A prepared response to be used if specified conditions arise. The usual combination is "activate a contingency plan".

C Not here. decision deadline: The latest time a decision is needed to support the stated plan. The usual combination is "state the decision deadline".

D Correct. risk register: A record of identified risks, assessment, ownership, and responses. The usual combination is "maintain the risk register".

Return to the exercise, page 31

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility". Rina: "Testing is planned for October thirteenth and requires the delivery. That is the immediate dependency we need to show in the escalation." Omar: [missing response] Rina: "Should we remove the original risk entry now? I do not want two records to make it look like two separate supplier problems." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. State the impact carefully. The planned test is threatened by the confirmed miss, but we still need a supported assessment of the full milestone consequence.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Rina says: "There may be a contingency in the procurement plan, but we should check its conditions and availability before saying it has solved the problem." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Rina says: "If we expedite or switch sources, we may create new costs or quality questions. The escalation should not present every response as an uncomplicated improvement." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Omar's response in turn 6. It connects Rina's preceding point with Rina's follow-up. Impact concerns the effect on the planned test and project objectives, which still needs assessment beyond the confirmed miss.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Rina says: "I will prepare a short decision request: confirmed miss, affected test, uncommitted replacement date, options under assessment, and the time when support is needed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 31

E / Conversation

1. issue

Turn 2. An issue is the confirmed commitment problem that now needs action, even though its final consequences remain uncertain.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. response status

Turn 4. Response status distinguishes a possible recovery date from an approved or completed response.

3. impact

Turn 6. Impact concerns the effect on the planned test and project objectives, which still needs assessment beyond the confirmed miss.

4. risk register

Turn 8. The risk register should preserve the original risk's history and link it to the current issue.

5. trigger

Turn 10. The trigger is the confirmed supplier miss that prompts the previously identified escalation response.

6. action owner

Turn 12. The action owner is responsible for the specific task of obtaining and reporting the supplier recovery information.

7. contingency plan

Turn 14. A contingency plan is a prepared response whose conditions and readiness must be checked before it is treated as active.

8. secondary risks

Turn 16. Secondary risks are new uncertainties introduced by the response, such as quality or integration exposure from switching suppliers.

9. escalation brief

Turn 18. An escalation brief connects the confirmed problem and consequences to the specific decision or support needed.

10. closure evidence

Turn 20. Closure evidence demonstrates that the defined issue-resolution conditions are met, not merely that a supplier sent a reassuring message.

Return to the conversation, page 33

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What should an escalation request include?

C. The confirmed problem, affected objective, options, decision owner, and needed timing

Decision-useful escalation connects the facts and consequences to specific help or authorization.

Return to the exercise, page 35

F2. Which item is a secondary risk of switching to an untested replacement supplier?

C. New integration uncertainty introduced by the replacement.

Secondary risk is new uncertainty created by the response. The existing miss is the original issue; an old probability and a record identifier are not new response-created exposures.

Return to the exercise, page 35

F / Guided speaking

1. confirmed

Manager: Tuesday's miss is confirmed.

Turn 1. The vendor explicitly states it cannot meet the Tuesday commitment.

2. uncommitted

Buyer: Thursday remains uncommitted.

Turn 2. The later date is only suggested, with no delivery commitment.

3. dependency

Manager: The Wednesday test has a delivery dependency.

Turn 3. The test requires the item, linking its timing to the vendor delivery.

4. approved

Buyer: No alternative has been approved.

Turn 4. The scenario supplies no authorized substitute or recovery arrangement.

Return to the conversation, page 36

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility". Rina: "There may be a contingency in the procurement plan, but we should check its conditions and availability before saying it has solved the problem." Omar: [missing response] Rina: "If we expedite or switch sources, we may create new costs or quality questions. The escalation should not present every response as an uncomplicated improvement." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Exactly. A contingency plan must be usable under the current facts. A named alternative is not automatically available, qualified, authorized, or fast enough for the test.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Rina says: "If we expedite or switch sources, we may create new costs or quality questions. The escalation should not present every response as an uncomplicated improvement." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Rina says: "I will prepare a short decision request: confirmed miss, affected test, uncommitted replacement date, options under assessment, and the time when support is needed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Omar's response in turn 14. It connects Rina's preceding point with Rina's follow-up. A contingency plan is a prepared response whose conditions and readiness must be checked before it is treated as active.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Rina says: "Testing is planned for October thirteenth and requires the delivery. That is the immediate dependency we need to show in the escalation." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 36

04 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Who holds the stated change authority?

B. The sponsor

The governance plan explicitly reserves this change decision to the sponsor.

Return to the exercise, page 37

A2. What did the steering group actually do?

D. Recommend a change

The brief describes a recommendation and says no sponsor decision or delegation is recorded.

Return to the exercise, page 37

A3. What may the group commission under the supplied remit?

D. Analysis of the proposal

The group can recommend and request analysis, which is distinct from authorizing implementation.

Return to the exercise, page 37

D / Response choices

D1. Which correction belongs in the minutes?

B. Change recommended; sponsor approval pending; analysis commissioned

The correction separates the actual recommendation and permitted analysis from missing approval.

Return to the exercise, page 41

D2. The group is quorate and unanimous. What remains necessary before implementing this change?

C. Sponsor approval or an explicit applicable delegation; quorum and agreement do not enlarge the stated remit.

Participation rules and support for a recommendation are different from the governance plan's reserved change authority.

Return to the exercise, page 41

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The area of responsibility and authority assigned to a person or group. Which term fits?

B. remit

A Not here. decision log: A record of actual decisions, authority, conditions, and dates. The usual combination is "maintain the decision log".

B Correct. remit: The area of responsibility and authority assigned to a person or group. The usual combination is "stay within the remit".

C Not here. accountability: Answerability for a defined decision or result. The usual combination is "assign accountability".

D Not here. recommendation: A proposed course of action submitted for consideration. The usual combination is "record a recommendation".

Return to the exercise, page 41

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A recommendation is not an approval". Simon: "Then I should tell the team we support the recommendation, but we have not authorized the build. Can you point me to the decision authority in our plan?" Rae: [missing response] Simon: "There may be a delegation somewhere, but I have not seen one. I should not ask the team to proceed on the assumption that it probably exists." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Exactly. Check the terms of reference. This group can recommend and commission analysis; it cannot treat its own enthusiasm as permission outside the authority the project has assigned.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Simon says: "We did assign someone to assess the impact. I want that work to proceed, because the sponsor will need a clearer comparison of the options." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Rae's response in turn 6. It connects Simon's preceding point with Simon's follow-up. Terms of reference define the steering group's remit, here recommendation and analysis rather than reserved change approval.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Simon says: "If the sponsor later approves with conditions, the delivery team needs those conditions too. The word approved on its own would still be incomplete." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Simon says: "I will read back the corrected result: recommendation supported, assessment commissioned, sponsor decision pending. Then we will send the paper through the stated route." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 41

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04 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. recommendation

Turn 2. A recommendation proposes a course of action; it does not establish the reserved sponsor approval.

2. quorum

Turn 4. A quorum satisfies the group's participation rules but does not expand its substantive decision authority.

3. terms of reference

Turn 6. Terms of reference define the steering group's remit, here recommendation and analysis rather than reserved change approval.

4. delegated authority

Turn 8. Delegated authority must be explicitly established; the team cannot infer it from a possible undocumented arrangement.

5. action log

Turn 10. The action log records the authorized assessment task, its owner, and deadline, not a decision to implement.

6. decision paper

Turn 12. A decision paper presents the options, consequences, and specific authorization requested from the proper decision maker.

7. authorization

Turn 14. Authorization identifies exactly which action is permitted; here analysis can proceed while implementation remains unapproved.

8. dissent

Turn 16. Dissent preserves relevant disagreement instead of falsely presenting the recommendation as unanimous or unqualified.

9. conditional approval

Turn 18. Conditional approval permits only the stated action under explicit conditions, whose status must remain visible.

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. decision log

Turn 20. The decision log should reflect actual decisions and their authority, not convert the meeting recommendation into approval.

Return to the conversation, page 43

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which task can proceed under the supplied facts?

D. Preparing the commissioned impact analysis

Commissioned analysis is within the group's stated remit, unlike the reserved change approval.

Return to the exercise, page 45

F2. Which record best captures conditional approval if it is later given?

A. The actual approver, permitted change, explicit conditions, and condition status

The conditions define the approval's scope and must not disappear during the handoff.

Return to the exercise, page 45

F / Guided speaking

1. recommendation

Chair: The committee has made a recommendation.

Turn 1. The committee supports an option without holding the reserved approval authority.

2. assessment

Manager: The authorized next task is the assessment.

Turn 2. The committee can commission the analysis requested in the briefing.

3. pending

Chair: The sponsor's decision is still pending.

Turn 3. The finance sponsor has not made the required decision.

4. authorized

Manager: Implementation is not yet authorized.

Turn 4. A recommendation and an assessment request do not approve the cost change.

Return to the conversation, page 46

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A recommendation is not an approval". Simon: "I will correct the minutes to say recommended rather than approved. Should we also explain that the analysis is authorized while implementation is not?" Rae: [missing response] Simon: "Keep the material objections in the paper too. The sponsor needs to see the concerns we discussed, not just a tidy statement that everyone agreed." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Yes. Keep authorization attached to the specific action. Otherwise the team may hear that work can proceed and assume that means the change itself.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Simon says: "What should the sponsor receive? Sending the meeting transcript would show the discussion, but might not make the actual choice very clear." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Simon says: "We had enough members present and everyone supported the proposal. Does that not give the group authority to move the change forward?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Simon says: "The meeting seemed aligned on changing the feature, and the notes say change approved. I assumed that reflected the room, but you have flagged the wording." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Rae's response in turn 14. It connects Simon's preceding point with Simon's follow-up. Authorization identifies exactly which action is permitted; here analysis can proceed while implementation remains unapproved.

Return to the exercise, page 46

05 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. How much effort is estimated for the new report?

B. Four person-days including testing

The brief gives a four-person-day estimate and explicitly includes testing.

Return to the exercise, page 49

A2. Which assessed option retains the launch date?

B. Defer the existing four-person-day export feature

The assessed substitution frees the effort needed for the new report while retaining the date.

Return to the exercise, page 49

A3. What is the status of both options?

B. They need approval.

The briefing states that neither option has yet received authorization.

Return to the exercise, page 49

D / Response choices

D1. Which option summary preserves the assessed trade-offs?

D. Defer the four-person-day export to retain the date, or keep all features with the assessed two-working-day extension; approval is pending.

Equal effort does not mean equal capability, and effort differs from elapsed duration. Each assessed option changes either delivered scope or timing and still needs authorization.

Return to the exercise, page 53

D2. Why does the four-person-day estimate not mean a four-day extension here?

B. Effort and elapsed duration differ; the assessed team plan gives two working days.

The supplied assessment distinguishes total work from elapsed schedule time with the planned resources.

Return to the exercise, page 53

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A record of proposed and decided project changes. Which term fits?

C. change log

A Not here. capacity limit: The amount of work the stated resources can support. The usual combination is "explain the capacity limit".

B Not here. approval record: Evidence of the actual authorization and its limits. The usual combination is "retain the approval record".

C Correct. change log: A record of proposed and decided project changes. The usual combination is "update the change log".

D Not here. benefit impact: The effect of a change on the value expected from the project. The usual combination is "assess benefit impact".

Return to the exercise, page 53

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Just one more report before launch". Nadia: "Please explain those options in terms of the launch and what users will receive. That will help me compare the value instead of debating whether four is a big number." Chen: [missing response] Nadia: "The date stays, but users lose the export from this release. Please put that beside the new report so nobody reads this as an addition with no loss." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The first is a scope substitution. Defer the existing four-person-day export feature and use that capacity for the new report, retaining the launch date.

A Correct. This is Chen's response in turn 6. It connects Nadia's preceding point with Nadia's follow-up. Scope substitution replaces the existing four-person-day export feature with the new report under an approved change.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Nadia says: "I understand it needs work. What does the estimate include? I do not want a build estimate that leaves testing to become a surprise later." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Nadia says: "The date stays, but users lose the export from this release. Please put that beside the new report so nobody reads this as an addition with no loss." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Nadia says: "We should compare the two options together: date retained with export deferred, or all features retained with a later launch. Neither means no trade-off." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 53

E / Conversation

1. change request

Turn 2. A change request captures the proposed new report so its effort, impacts, and approval can be assessed.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. effort estimate

Turn 4. The effort estimate is four person-days and explicitly includes testing rather than counting only construction.

3. scope substitution

Turn 6. Scope substitution replaces the existing four-person-day export feature with the new report under an approved change.

4. benefit impact

Turn 8. Benefit impact concerns the value affected when the planned export is deferred, even though the launch date is retained.

5. elapsed duration

Turn 10. Elapsed duration is the schedule time; this option extends it by two working days, distinct from four person-days of effort.

6. test coverage

Turn 12. Test coverage remains within the assessed work; silently dropping required checks is not one of the options.

7. option comparison

Turn 14. The option comparison presents both alternatives on a common scope, time, and assumption basis.

8. approval record

Turn 16. The approval record must reflect the actual decision; no option has been authorized in this conversation.

9. decision latency

Turn 18. Decision latency is the time taken to receive the needed choice, which can change the feasibility of the assessed options.

10. baseline revision

Turn 20. A baseline revision updates the controlled plan after approval and communicates the selected scope and timing.

Return to the conversation, page 55

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What must the date-preserving option disclose?

D. The existing export will be deferred from this release.

The option preserves time by changing scope, so the removed capability must remain explicit.

Return to the exercise, page 57

F2. What turns an addition into uncontrolled scope creep?

A. Implementing extra work without the required assessment and authorization

Controlled changes can be legitimate; uncontrolled expansion bypasses the project's stated decision process.

Return to the exercise, page 57

F / Guided speaking

1. effort

Sponsor: The new feature requires three person-days of effort.

Turn 1. Person-days measure the estimated work, not an automatic number of elapsed days.

2. substitution

Manager: Keeping the date requires the assessed scope substitution.

Turn 2. The stated option replaces one feature with another to release capacity.

3. deferred

Sponsor: The original feature would be deferred.

Turn 3. The date-preserving option removes that feature from the current delivery.

4. approval

Manager: The option still needs approval.

Turn 4. The briefing says no option is authorized, so implementation cannot be assumed.

Return to the conversation, page 58

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Just one more report before launch". Nadia: "We should compare the two options together: date retained with export deferred, or all features retained with a later launch. Neither means no trade-off." Chen: [missing response] Nadia: "I am not choosing an option in this conversation yet. I need to confirm the export's importance with the operations lead before making the decision." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. That is the option comparison. Include the assumptions and any relevant consequences so the decision is about the actual alternatives, not a more attractive label.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Nadia says: "The date stays, but users lose the export from this release. Please put that beside the new report so nobody reads this as an addition with no loss." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Nadia says: "I understand it needs work. What does the estimate include? I do not want a build estimate that leaves testing to become a surprise later." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Chen's response in turn 14. It connects Nadia's preceding point with Nadia's follow-up. The option comparison presents both alternatives on a common scope, time, and assumption basis.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Nadia says: "Please explain those options in terms of the launch and what users will receive. That will help me compare the value instead of debating whether four is a big number." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 58

06 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What does eight of ten establish?

B. Eighty percent of the task count is complete.

The brief supplies an unweighted task count, not effort weighting or complete delivery evidence.

Return to the exercise, page 59

A2. Why does the access approval matter?

C. It is needed for the rehearsal that precedes launch.

The stated chain links access due October 9 to rehearsal and the planned launch.

Return to the exercise, page 59

A3. Which rating matches the supplied rules and facts?

C. Amber

The rules require amber for a material threat needing management attention, which the open dependency creates.

Return to the exercise, page 59

D / Response choices

D1. Which executive summary is best supported?

A. Amber: access due October 9 is unconfirmed; rehearsal and launch are exposed; owner and decision follow-up needed.

This summary follows the stated criteria and names the material dependency without inventing a final delay.

Return to the exercise, page 63

D2. Why is "80% of the project is done" too broad?

D. Only unweighted task counts are supplied.

Task-count completion does not establish weighted effort, value, or the importance of remaining work.

Return to the exercise, page 63

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A red-amber-green status classification under stated criteria. Which term fits?

B. RAG rating

A Not here. percent complete: Completion expressed as a percentage under a specified measurement basis. The usual combination is "define percent complete".

B Correct. RAG rating: A red-amber-green status classification under stated criteria. The usual combination is "apply the RAG rating".

C Not here. key milestone: A major event used to judge project progress or readiness. The usual combination is "report a key milestone".

D Not here. cost performance index: Earned value divided by actual cost, commonly CPI. The usual combination is "interpret the cost performance index".

Return to the exercise, page 63

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened". James: "Please state the dates in the short update. I need to see the point at which the missing approval affects the rest of the plan." Sofia: [missing response] James: "We do not yet know that launch will be late, though. I want the report to show the threat without declaring a final outcome the evidence does not establish." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. The dependency due date is October ninth. Rehearsal is planned for October twelfth, ahead of the October sixteenth launch, so the approval cannot remain an unrelated footnote.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after James says: "Keep the eight completed tasks in the update, but put the access problem first. Which unfinished task is driving the threat to rehearsal?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after James says: "We do not yet know that launch will be late, though. I want the report to show the threat without declaring a final outcome the evidence does not establish." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Sofia's response in turn 6. It connects James's preceding point with James's follow-up. The dependency due date is October 9, when approval is needed to support the planned rehearsal.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after James says: "The report is green and shows eight of ten tasks complete. That sounds encouraging, but I see the access approval is still open. Does it affect the rehearsal?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 63

E / Conversation

1. RAG rating

Turn 2. The RAG rating must follow the stated criteria, including material threats, rather than simply count completed tasks.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. task-count completion

Turn 4. Task-count completion is eight finished tasks out of ten, without weighting their size or importance.

3. dependency due date

Turn 6. The dependency due date is October 9, when approval is needed to support the planned rehearsal.

4. confidence qualifier

Turn 8. A confidence qualifier distinguishes the planned date from the uncertainty created by the unresolved dependency.

5. dependency owner

Turn 10. The dependency owner is accountable for managing the required access input and its follow-up.

6. executive ask

Turn 12. The executive ask requests support for a timely authorized decision, not permission to bypass the required control.

7. Earned value

Turn 14. Earned value measures budgeted completed work under a defined method; unweighted task counts do not provide it.

8. exception report

Turn 16. An exception report focuses attention on the condition needing action while preserving its relevant progress context.

9. Delivery confidence

Turn 18. Delivery confidence concerns the remaining path to the intended outcome, not merely how many historical tasks are complete.

10. status date

Turn 20. The status date identifies when the report's facts and outlook apply, making later changes traceable.

Return to the conversation, page 65

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. A colleague divides eight completed tasks by ten total tasks and labels 0.8 as CPI. What is missing?

C. Earned value and actual cost under a defined measurement basis.

CPI compares earned value with actual cost. Task counts supply neither quantity and do not measure the cost efficiency of completed work.

Return to the exercise, page 69

F2. Which wording preserves uncertainty accurately?

B. October 16 remains planned, but the unconfirmed dependency creates a material threat.

The wording distinguishes the planned date from confidence in meeting it.

Return to the exercise, page 69

F / Guided speaking

1. seventy-five

Lead: Task-count completion is seventy-five percent.

Turn 1. Six divided by eight equals seventy-five percent of the listed task count.

2. progress

Sponsor: That does not establish weighted progress.

Turn 2. No effort or value weights are supplied for the eight tasks.

3. amber

Lead: Under our rules, the rating is amber.

Turn 3. The stated local rules assign amber to the material unresolved dependency.

4. confirmed

Sponsor: A final delay is not yet confirmed.

Turn 4. The briefing identifies a threat without establishing a final delay.

Return to the conversation, page 70

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened". James: "The report also uses the words value delivered beside the eighty-percent figure. We do not have an earned-value calculation here, do we?" Sofia: [missing response] James: "Remove the unsupported value label. Give me progress, the access threat, the needed decision, and the deadline in one short update for the sponsor group." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. No. Earned value needs its defined work and budget basis. The task count supplies neither that measure nor the actual cost needed for a cost-performance calculation.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after James says: "The report is green and shows eight of ten tasks complete. That sounds encouraging, but I see the access approval is still open. Does it affect the rehearsal?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after James says: "Please state the dates in the short update. I need to see the point at which the missing approval affects the rest of the plan." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Sofia's response in turn 14. It connects James's preceding point with James's follow-up. Earned value measures budgeted completed work under a defined method; unweighted task counts do not provide it.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after James says: "We do not yet know that launch will be late, though. I want the report to show the threat without declaring a final outcome the evidence does not establish." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 70

07 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. How many criteria currently have verified evidence?

C. Four of six

Leo can verify four criteria; C5 and C6 lack evidence in the current record.

Return to the exercise, page 73

A2. What follows from missing evidence for C5 and C6?

C. Their compliance has not yet been demonstrated in the record.

Missing proof leaves acceptance unresolved without establishing that the underlying functions fail.

Return to the exercise, page 73

A3. Who may waive the criteria under the supplied facts?

A. The appropriate authority, which Leo cannot replace alone

The brief explicitly says Leo cannot waive the criteria alone and records no waiver.

Return to the exercise, page 73

D / Response choices

D1. Which response preserves both accuracy and scope?

A. Please supply evidence for the existing C5 and C6 criteria; we are not adding new requirements.

The response requests the missing proof against the agreed scope without inventing failure or extra work.

Return to the exercise, page 77

D2. A C5 screenshot comes from an earlier build. What is the appropriate response?

A. Check its applicability and traceability to the delivered version before treating C5 as demonstrated.

A result must be tied to the relevant criterion and version. An earlier result is neither automatically applicable evidence nor proof of a functional failure.

Return to the exercise, page 77

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The person or body empowered to accept the deliverable. Which term fits?

C. acceptance authority

A Not here. punch list: A list of remaining items to address before a defined completion point. The usual combination is "maintain a punch list".

B Not here. commercial consequence: An effect on contractual or financial obligations requiring the governing terms. The usual combination is "assess commercial consequences".

C Correct. acceptance authority: The person or body empowered to accept the deliverable. The usual combination is "identify the acceptance authority".

D Not here. test environment: The conditions and setup in which a test is performed. The usual combination is "identify the test environment".

Return to the exercise, page 77

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted". Marta: "Understood. I was worried you had added requirements after delivery. Can we point the test lead back to the original acceptance criteria?" Leo: [missing response] Marta: "I found an export screenshot, but it is from an earlier build. Would sending it let you close C5 on the delivered version?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Yes, use the existing statement of work and the agreed C5 and C6 identifiers. I am requesting support for those requirements, not a new feature.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Marta says: "I will tell our team: four criteria verified, C5 and C6 awaiting evidence, package or gap update at 14:00, client check at 14:30. No waiver is recorded." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Marta says: "I found an export screenshot, but it is from an earlier build. Would sending it let you close C5 on the delivered version?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Leo's response in turn 6. It connects Marta's preceding point with Marta's follow-up. The statement of work and agreed criteria define the original delivery scope, not new requirements invented during acceptance.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Marta says: "I will send the evidence package or an itemized gap update by 14:00. Can you confirm who receives it and when you will check what arrived?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 77

E / Conversation

1. completion claim

Turn 2. A completion claim is the vendor's statement of finished work, distinct from the client's acceptance evidence.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. evidence gap

Turn 4. An evidence gap means the supporting information is missing, not that the function has been proven defective.

3. statement of work

Turn 6. The statement of work and agreed criteria define the original delivery scope, not new requirements invented during acceptance.

4. requirements matrix

Turn 8. The requirements matrix connects each criterion identifier with the relevant version, status, and supporting result.

5. actual result

Turn 10. The actual result is the recorded behavior observed in the identified test, to be compared with the expected result.

6. waiver

Turn 12. A waiver is an authorized exception; Leo does not have unilateral authority to remove the two criteria.

7. conditional acceptance

Turn 14. Conditional acceptance needs the relevant authority and explicit conditions; it is not established by discussing the option.

8. evidence handoff

Turn 16. The evidence handoff specifies who sends the missing results, where they are available, and when review can occur.

9. contract owner

Turn 18. The contract owner must assess commercial consequences against the governing agreement rather than a generic completion label.

10. acceptance record

Turn 20. The acceptance record should capture the actual authorized decision after evidence review, not convert delivery status into acceptance.

Return to the conversation, page 79

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which acceptance status is supported now?

A. No acceptance or waiver is recorded.

The brief explicitly leaves acceptance and waiver absent and limits Leo's authority.

Return to the exercise, page 81

F2. What should be said about payment consequences?

A. They need assessment against the agreement by the appropriate owner.

The supplied facts do not establish the contractual payment rules or authorize a commercial conclusion.

Return to the exercise, page 81

F / Guided speaking

1. evidence

Client: Four criteria have supporting evidence.

Turn 1. The briefing says four of the five criteria have demonstrated support.

2. unverified

Vendor: The fifth remains unverified.

Turn 2. Its result is missing, so compliance has not yet been demonstrated.

3. failure

Client: That does not itself prove a failure.

Turn 3. Missing information is not evidence that the underlying function failed.

4. recorded

Vendor: No acceptance has been recorded.

Turn 4. The supplied facts explicitly leave the acceptance record absent.

Return to the conversation, page 82

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted". Marta: "Could we request acceptance subject to later evidence? I am asking whether that is an option, not saying you have already accepted it." Leo: [missing response] Marta: "I will send the evidence package or an itemized gap update by 14:00. Can you confirm who receives it and when you will check what arrived?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Any conditional acceptance needs an authorized decision and explicit conditions. We have no such decision recorded, so the current acceptance status remains open.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Marta says: "Our delivery tracker says complete, but your sheet still has two open criteria. Is this a disagreement about the work or about the handover evidence?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Marta says: "If the evidence is not ready today, could you remove those two criteria from the sheet so our delivery record can close?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Leo's response in turn 14. It connects Marta's preceding point with Marta's follow-up. Conditional acceptance needs the relevant authority and explicit conditions; it is not established by discussing the option.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Marta says: "I will ask for the setup, input data, and expected behavior as well. A screenshot labeled passed does not show what the test actually checked." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 82

08 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. How many reviewed handoffs lacked recorded acknowledgment before work?

D. Three of five

The briefing identifies three missing acknowledgments among five examined handoffs.

Return to the exercise, page 83

A2. What is established about the rework?

A. Two tasks used an older specification and were reworked.

The record describes two reworked tasks but does not establish a complete causal explanation.

Return to the exercise, page 83

A3. What is the status of the proposed improvement?

A. Proposed, with no pilot result yet

The briefing supplies a proposed action and review plan, not results.

Return to the exercise, page 83

D / Response choices

D1. Which action is most specific?

C. Sanjay revises the handoff record by October 10 and checks required fields in the next five handoffs.

The action identifies an owner, deliverable, deadline, and observable follow-up sample.

Return to the exercise, page 87

D2. Why does a published template not prove effectiveness?

C. Existence, use, and effect are different questions.

The team must examine adoption and outcomes separately from the creation of the document.

Return to the exercise, page 87

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Learning translated into a specific usable change. Which term fits?

A. actionable lesson

A Correct. actionable lesson: Learning translated into a specific usable change. The usual combination is "formulate an actionable lesson".

B Not here. sample size: The number of observations in an assessment. The usual combination is "state the sample size".

C Not here. adoption check: A check that the intended process is actually being used. The usual combination is "perform an adoption check".

D Not here. knowledge transfer: Passing usable information or experience to another team. The usual combination is "improve knowledge transfer".

Return to the exercise, page 87

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Turn communication was poor into a testable action". Hana: "Let us define a change that addresses the gap without pretending the analysis is finished. What should the handoff record contain that it does not reliably show now?" Sanjay: [missing response] Hana: "Who will produce the revised record, and by when? A lesson saying someone should improve the template may disappear as soon as the project closes." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Add the scope identifier, version reference, responsible owner, and recipient acknowledgment before work starts. That makes the transferred instruction identifiable rather than leaving the receiver to infer which document applies.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Hana says: "Once the template is published, who checks that people actually use it? I do not want the action closed while the next handoff still lacks an acknowledgment." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Hana says: "Five cases is also a small sample. We can use it to spot a problem with the process, but not claim a universal result from a short pilot." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Sanjay's response in turn 6. It connects Hana's preceding point with Hana's follow-up. The version reference identifies which specification the receiving team is meant to use.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Hana says: "Who will produce the revised record, and by when? A lesson saying someone should improve the template may disappear as soon as the project closes." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 87

E / Conversation

1. recipient acknowledgment

Turn 2. Recipient acknowledgment is the receiving person's confirmation, missing before work began in three reviewed cases.

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. causal claim

Turn 4. A causal claim would assert that the missing acknowledgment produced the rework, which this record does not establish exclusively.

3. version reference

Turn 6. The version reference identifies which specification the receiving team is meant to use.

4. process owner

Turn 8. The process owner is accountable for the defined handoff process and its proposed improvement, here Sanjay.

5. adoption check

Turn 10. An adoption check examines whether the revised process appears in actual handoff records, not merely whether the template exists.

6. baseline value

Turn 12. The baseline value is two acknowledged handoffs out of five, or 40%, under the defined process measure.

7. process measure

Turn 14. The process measure tracks recorded acknowledgment, which is distinct from an outcome such as less version-related rework.

8. effectiveness review

Turn 16. An effectiveness review tests whether the adopted change improves the intended result rather than stopping at procedural compliance.

9. sample size

Turn 18. Sample size is the number of observed handoffs and limits the strength of broader conclusions.

10. closure criterion

Turn 20. The closure criterion specifies the evidence required to complete the improvement action, keeping implementation and effectiveness distinct.

Return to the conversation, page 89

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. A later pilot moves recorded acknowledgment from two of five to four of five. Which interpretation is accurate?

A. The rate rises from 40% to 80%, up 40 percentage points and 100% relatively, while missing the five-of-five target.

The point difference is 80 minus 40; the relative increase is 40 divided by 40. One handoff still misses the target, and rework effectiveness is a separate measure.

Return to the exercise, page 92

F2. What does a small improved before-and-after result establish by itself?

B. An observed difference in the measured cases, not proof of an exclusive cause

A small comparison can show a change without isolating causality or supporting a universal guarantee.

Return to the exercise, page 92

F / Guided speaking

1. fifty

Reviewer: The baseline rate was fifty percent.

Turn 1. Three acknowledged handoffs divided by six gives a fifty-percent baseline.

2. five

Owner: The pilot has five acknowledged handoffs out of six.

Turn 2. The supplied pilot result records acknowledgment in five of the six cases.

3. unmet

Reviewer: The six-of-six target remains unmet.

Turn 3. One pilot handoff still lacks acknowledgment, so the stated target was not achieved.

4. measured

Owner: Rework effectiveness is not yet measured.

Turn 4. The briefing explicitly leaves rework outcomes without measurement.

Return to the conversation, page 93

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Turn communication was poor into a testable action". Hana: "Suppose the pilot later shows four of five. That would be progress, but the target would still be unmet, and it would not tell us everything about rework." Sanjay: [missing response] Hana: "Keep a separate check on version-related rework. A fully completed form will not tell us whether the team actually used the right specification." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. The process measure would be eighty percent. That is forty percentage points above baseline, not evidence that every intended outcome has been achieved.

A Correct. This is Sanjay's response in turn 14. It connects Hana's preceding point with Hana's follow-up. The process measure tracks recorded acknowledgment, which is distinct from an outcome such as less version-related rework.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Hana says: "The review notes say communication was poor three times, but I cannot find an action that would change the next project. What did the records actually show?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Hana says: "Keep a separate check on version-related rework. A fully completed form will not tell us whether the team actually used the right specification." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Hana says: "Those are more useful observations than the broad label. Do they prove that the missing acknowledgment was the sole cause of the rework?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 93

Review 1 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The problem or opportunity the work is intended to address. Which term fits?

B. business need

A Not here. work breakdown structure: A hierarchical division of project work into manageable components, abbreviated WBS. The usual combination is "develop the work breakdown structure".

B Correct. business need: The problem or opportunity the work is intended to address. The usual combination is "clarify the business need".

C Not here. constraint: A limit within which the project must operate. The usual combination is "identify a constraint".

D Not here. benefit: A measurable improvement of value from the change. The usual combination is "define the expected benefit".

Return to the exercise, page 25

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A task whose timing depends on a linked earlier task. Which term fits?

C. successor

A Not here. schedule baseline: The approved timing reference used to assess project progress. The usual combination is "compare with the schedule baseline".

B Not here. total float: Time an activity can move without delaying the defined project finish under the schedule model. The usual combination is "assess total float".

C Correct. successor: A task whose timing depends on a linked earlier task. The usual combination is "assess the successor".

D Not here. fast-tracking: Overlapping work that was planned in sequence, with resulting risks. The usual combination is "assess fast-tracking".

Return to the exercise, page 25

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A dashboard is not yet a defined project". Greg: "We should probably define what shows that the view is adequate. Otherwise I might approve a demonstration and discover later that it cannot support the weekly meeting." Elena: [missing response] Greg: "I need to check my assumption about the data. The records exist, but the data team has not confirmed that this project can access them." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. We need an acceptance criterion for each relevant requirement. We also need to identify who can accept the output and what evidence they will review.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Greg says: "I am comfortable reviewing a clearer definition first. It should show the user, the two requested capabilities, the exclusion, and the open access question." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Greg says: "Then four weeks may still be possible, but I should not tell other departments it is an approved delivery promise simply because I prefer that date." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Greg says: "I do not need automated work allocation in the first version. That might become useful later, but visibility and an export are the immediate request." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Elena's response in turn 10. It connects Greg's preceding point with Greg's follow-up. An acceptance criterion makes adequacy checkable instead of relying on a favorable demonstration impression.

Return to the exercise, page 25

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "One late task can move the release". Anika: "Neither proposal has been assessed and approved. For now I will keep day eleven as the current estimate, with the original day eight still visible." Luis: [missing response] Anika: "My sponsor update will explain the blocked rehearsal, three-day milestone movement, unchanged assumptions, and recovery options still under review. It will not announce recovered time." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Update the schedule forecast that way. Do not replace the approved reference merely to make the report show no difference.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Anika says: "If testing now finishes at the end of day eight, could rehearsal still start that morning? Both dates would say day eight on the chart." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Luis's response in turn 18. It connects Anika's preceding point with Anika's follow-up. The schedule forecast is the current timing estimate; updating it does not silently authorize a new baseline.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Anika says: "Could adding testers shorten the remaining work? I can ask for an assessment, but some test steps may depend on the same environment." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Anika says: "Let me reconstruct the original sequence first. Testing through day five, then two days of rehearsal, then one day for approval. Was release originally day eight?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 25

Review 2 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Uncertainty with a potentially beneficial effect on an objective. Which term fits?

A. opportunity

A Correct. opportunity: Uncertainty with a potentially beneficial effect on an objective. The usual combination is "assess an opportunity".

B Not here. mitigation: Action intended to reduce a threat's likelihood or impact. The usual combination is "assess mitigation".

C Not here. action owner: The person responsible for carrying out a particular response action. The usual combination is "name the action owner".

D Not here. escalation brief: A concise statement of the problem, consequence, and help or decision needed. The usual combination is "prepare an escalation brief".

Return to the exercise, page 47

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Defined responsibility for making particular decisions. Which term fits?

C. decision rights

A Not here. governance: The arrangements for project direction, decisions, oversight, and accountability. The usual combination is "clarify project governance".

B Not here. stage gate: A defined review point for an authorization or continuation decision. The usual combination is "prepare for a stage gate".

C Correct. decision rights: Defined responsibility for making particular decisions. The usual combination is "confirm decision rights".

D Not here. consensus: Broad agreement among participants on a stated matter. The usual combination is "establish the scope of consensus".

Return to the exercise, page 47

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "One late task can move the release". Anika: "I will show end of day eleven against end of day eight. These are working-day numbers, not three ordinary dates on a calendar." Luis: [missing response] Anika: "Another team says its tasks have four days available. Could I transfer those four days to testing and cancel our three-day delay?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. Keep the working calendar consistent. A weekend or holiday must be handled through the dated schedule, not silently counted differently between the two versions.

A Correct. This is Luis's response in turn 10. It connects Anika's preceding point with Anika's follow-up. The working calendar defines available workdays and must be consistent across the baseline and forecast calculation.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Anika says: "Another team says its tasks have four days available. Could I transfer those four days to testing and cancel our three-day delay?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Anika says: "The other proposal starts some rehearsal before testing finishes. That sounds different from adding people and could require rehearsal to be repeated." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Anika says: "Most of the project is on schedule, but testing has moved from day five to day eight. Can I leave the release milestone unchanged in the sponsor report?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 47

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A recommendation is not an approval". Simon: "If the sponsor later approves with conditions, the delivery team needs those conditions too. The word approved on its own would still be incomplete." Rae: [missing response] Simon: "I will read back the corrected result: recommendation supported, assessment commissioned, sponsor decision pending. Then we will send the paper through the stated route." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. A conditional approval must state the limits and what must be satisfied. We should not silently treat an unmet condition as though it has already been cleared.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Simon says: "We did assign someone to assess the impact. I want that work to proceed, because the sponsor will need a clearer comparison of the options." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Simon says: "I will read back the corrected result: recommendation supported, assessment commissioned, sponsor decision pending. Then we will send the paper through the stated route." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Simon says: "The meeting seemed aligned on changing the feature, and the notes say change approved. I assumed that reflected the room, but you have flagged the wording." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Rae's response in turn 18. It connects Simon's preceding point with Simon's follow-up. Conditional approval permits only the stated action under explicit conditions, whose status must remain visible.

Return to the exercise, page 47

Review 3 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Uncontrolled growth in project work without corresponding assessment and authorization. Which term fits?

D. scope creep

A Not here. opportunity cost: Value forgone by choosing one use of resources over another. The usual combination is "explain the opportunity cost".

B Not here. baseline revision: An authorized update to the controlled project reference. The usual combination is "record a baseline revision".

C Not here. elapsed duration: The time passing from an activity's start to finish. The usual combination is "distinguish elapsed duration".

D Correct. scope creep: Uncontrolled growth in project work without corresponding assessment and authorization. The usual combination is "prevent scope creep".

Return to the exercise, page 71

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An assessment of the likelihood of achieving the intended delivery outcome. Which term fits?

B. delivery confidence

A Not here. lagging indicator: A measure of an outcome that has already occurred. The usual combination is "distinguish a lagging indicator".

B Correct. delivery confidence: An assessment of the likelihood of achieving the intended delivery outcome. The usual combination is "assess delivery confidence".

C Not here. status report: A periodic account of progress, outlook, problems, and decisions needed. The usual combination is "prepare a status report".

D Not here. planned value: The budgeted value of work planned by the status date. The usual combination is "compare with planned value".

Return to the exercise, page 71

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A recommendation is not an approval". Simon: "We did assign someone to assess the impact. I want that work to proceed, because the sponsor will need a clearer comparison of the options." Rae: [missing response] Simon: "What should the sponsor receive? Sending the meeting transcript would show the discussion, but might not make the actual choice very clear." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Put that in the action log. The task is to prepare analysis with an owner and deadline; it is not an instruction to implement the feature change.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Simon says: "I will read back the corrected result: recommendation supported, assessment commissioned, sponsor decision pending. Then we will send the paper through the stated route." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Simon says: "The meeting seemed aligned on changing the feature, and the notes say change approved. I assumed that reflected the room, but you have flagged the wording." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Simon says: "If the sponsor later approves with conditions, the delivery team needs those conditions too. The word approved on its own would still be incomplete." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Rae's response in turn 10. It connects Simon's preceding point with Simon's follow-up. The action log records the authorized assessment task, its owner, and deadline, not a decision to implement.

Return to the exercise, page 71

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened". James: "I agree that amber follows our rules. It is not a punishment for the team; it tells us where management attention can still make a difference." Sofia: [missing response] James: "Please correct the report and confirm the next checkpoint. Keep the October sixteenth baseline visible while distinguishing it from any later forecast we may need." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Correct. Delivery confidence depends on the remaining work and dependencies, not just historical completion. The rating should change when the relevant evidence changes.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after James says: "The report is green and shows eight of ten tasks complete. That sounds encouraging, but I see the access approval is still open. Does it affect the rehearsal?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after James says: "The report also uses the words value delivered beside the eighty-percent figure. We do not have an earned-value calculation here, do we?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after James says: "We do not yet know that launch will be late, though. I want the report to show the threat without declaring a final outcome the evidence does not establish." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Sofia's response in turn 18. It connects James's preceding point with James's follow-up. Delivery confidence concerns the remaining path to the intended outcome, not merely how many historical tasks are complete.

Return to the exercise, page 71

Review 4 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The arrangement for checking and deciding acceptance of outputs. Which term fits?

B. acceptance plan

A Not here. nonconformance: Failure to meet an applicable specified requirement. The usual combination is "document a nonconformance".

B Correct. acceptance plan: The arrangement for checking and deciding acceptance of outputs. The usual combination is "confirm the acceptance plan".

C Not here. completion claim: A party's statement that its work is finished. The usual combination is "verify a completion claim".

D Not here. test result: The recorded outcome of a defined test. The usual combination is "review a test result".

Return to the exercise, page 94

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A learning-focused review that avoids unsupported personal blame without removing accountability. Which term fits?

A. blameless review

A Correct. blameless review: A learning-focused review that avoids unsupported personal blame without removing accountability. The usual combination is "hold a blameless review".

B Not here. process owner: The person accountable for a defined working process. The usual combination is "identify the process owner".

C Not here. baseline value: The reference measurement before the assessed change. The usual combination is "establish the baseline value".

D Not here. post-implementation review: An assessment after delivery of results, process, and lessons. The usual combination is "conduct a post-implementation review".

Return to the exercise, page 94

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened". James: "Who is responsible for obtaining the approval? A clear owner would help me understand where support is needed instead of sending a general chase to everyone." Sofia: [missing response] James: "I can help bring the decision to the right forum, but I cannot treat the urgency as permission to bypass the access approval itself." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Identify the dependency owner and the authorized decision route. The report should say who is following up, what decision is required, and when the next status check will occur.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after James says: "Keep the eight completed tasks in the update, but put the access problem first. Which unfinished task is driving the threat to rehearsal?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after James says: "I can help bring the decision to the right forum, but I cannot treat the urgency as permission to bypass the access approval itself." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Sofia's response in turn 10. It connects James's preceding point with James's follow-up. The dependency owner is accountable for managing the required access input and its follow-up.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after James says: "Remove the unsupported value label. Give me progress, the access threat, the needed decision, and the deadline in one short update for the sponsor group." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 94

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Turn communication was poor into a testable action". Hana: "Five cases is also a small sample. We can use it to spot a problem with the process, but not claim a universal result from a short pilot." Sanjay: [missing response] Hana: "That gives us an action, an owner, a deadline, and two different checks: whether the process is used and whether it helps. How should we close it?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. State the sample size whenever reporting the result. Keep other possible influences visible instead of treating a before-and-after difference as proof that our change was the only cause.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Hana says: "Who will produce the revised record, and by when? A lesson saying someone should improve the template may disappear as soon as the project closes." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Hana says: "What is the comparison point? We need a clear measure so a later reviewer can tell whether the process changed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Sanjay's response in turn 18. It connects Hana's preceding point with Hana's follow-up. Sample size is the number of observed handoffs and limits the strength of broader conclusions.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Hana says: "Once the template is published, who checks that people actually use it? I do not want the action closed while the next handoff still lacks an acknowledgment." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 94

Additional case 1 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. planned value

Turn 2. Planned value is the budget assigned to work scheduled by the reporting date, not the value of the work actually completed.

2. earned value

Turn 4. Earned value is the budgeted value of work actually performed under the agreed measurement method, here $45,000.

3. cost variance

Turn 6. Cost variance is earned value minus actual cost: $45,000 minus $50,000 gives negative $5,000.

4. cost performance index

Turn 8. The cost performance index is earned value divided by actual cost; $45,000 divided by $50,000 equals 0.90.

5. schedule variance

Turn 10. The earned-value schedule variance is earned value minus planned value: $45,000 minus $60,000 equals negative $15,000 of budgeted work.

6. estimate at completion

Turn 14. An estimate at completion forecasts total final cost using a justified method and assumptions; the three supplied current-period measures alone do not provide it.

Return to the conversation, page 97

Transfer exchange

1. cost

Sponsor: Cost variance compares earned value with actual cost.

Turn 1. The cost variance uses earned value minus actual cost, not planned value minus spending.

Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

2. variance

Analyst: Fifteen thousand minus eighteen thousand gives a negative three-thousand-dollar variance.

Turn 2. The calculation shows a $3,000 unfavorable cost variance on the work performed.

3. value

Sponsor: The schedule comparison uses the twenty-thousand-dollar planned value.

Turn 3. Planned value provides the scheduled-work basis for the earned-value schedule comparison.

4. delay

Analyst: A monetary schedule variance is not a calendar-day delay.

Turn 4. Earned-value schedule variance measures budgeted work and cannot be read directly as days late.

Return to the conversation, page 100

Additional case 2 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. Sprint Goal

Turn 2. The Sprint Goal is the sprint's single objective; here it concerns finding an overdue case and its owner, not an unrelated visual request.

2. Sprint Backlog

Turn 4. The Sprint Backlog is the Developers' current plan for the Sprint Goal and selected work; it can be adapted as more is learned.

3. Definition of Done

Turn 8. The Definition of Done describes the required quality state of the Increment; dropping required checks to fit extra work would not satisfy it.

4. Product Backlog

Turn 9. The Product Backlog is the ordered list of what is needed to improve the product; adding an item there does not promise delivery in the current sprint.

5. Daily Scrum

Turn 12. The Daily Scrum is for the Developers to inspect progress toward the Sprint Goal and adapt their plan, not a manager's task-allocation meeting.

6. Increment

Turn 16. An Increment must meet the Definition of Done to be usable; a demonstration of unfinished work does not make that work Done.

Return to the conversation, page 102

Transfer exchange

1. Done

Product Owner: The demonstration does not establish that the item is Done.

Turn 1. The required quality criteria remain incomplete despite the successful demonstration.

Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

2. plan

Developer: Keep the unfinished checks visible in the current plan.

Turn 2. The Developers' plan should show the actual remaining work instead of hiding it.

3. request

Product Owner: Do not drop required quality work to accept an extra request.

Turn 3. Adding scope does not justify lowering the Definition of Done.

4. Goal

Developer: Explain progress against the agreed Sprint Goal.

Turn 4. The Sprint Goal provides the objective for assessing progress and adapting the plan.

Return to the conversation, page 105

Additional case 3 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. operational acceptance

Turn 2. Operational acceptance establishes that the agreed conditions for taking responsibility are met; completing training does not settle every support requirement.

2. support model

Turn 4. The support model defines who handles incidents, how they are routed, and when coverage is available for the service.

3. escalation matrix

Turn 6. The escalation matrix identifies the roles and routes for unresolved or serious issues; it needs actual owners and coverage rather than unconfirmed names.

4. runbook

Turn 8. A runbook gives the approved operational procedures and relevant response information for the service; training attendance alone does not provide that resource.

5. defect ownership

Turn 10. Defect ownership assigns responsibility for tracking and resolving each defect after transition; an open list without owners leaves the work unassigned.

6. hypercare

Turn 12. Hypercare is a defined period of enhanced support after a change; its label does not establish staffing, responsibilities, or completion conditions.

Return to the conversation, page 107

Transfer exchange

1. staffed

Service owner: The support period is proposed, not yet staffed.

Turn 1. The plan names a period but does not identify committed people to provide coverage.

Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

2. route

Project lead: Confirm responsibilities and the incident contact route.

Turn 2. Operational teams need a known way to obtain help from the responsible support roles.

3. support

Service owner: Define the conditions for ending enhanced support.

Turn 3. Exit conditions establish when the additional support can end on an agreed basis.

4. review

Project lead: Keep unresolved conditions visible at the acceptance review.

Turn 4. The acceptance review must consider actual gaps rather than infer readiness from a promised period.

Return to the conversation, page 110

Find a phrase by purpose

Project Charter and Scope Definition

Clarify the need: Which decision should the dashboard help users make?

Name the audience: The proposed first users are operations leads.

Anchor the task: They will use it for weekly queue triage.

Full phrase bank, page 7

Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies

Start with the movement: Testing is forecast to finish three working days late.

State the comparison: The baseline finish is day 5; the current forecast is day 8.

Name the blocked step: Rehearsal cannot start until testing finishes.

Full phrase bank, page 17

Risk Register and Issue Escalation

State the confirmed event: The supplier has confirmed it will miss October 12.

Correct the old wording: Possible delay no longer describes the commitment status.

Preserve uncertainty: The replacement delivery date is not committed.

Full phrase bank, page 30

Stakeholder Alignment and Governance

Check the record: The minutes say approved, but the group made a recommendation.

Name the authority: The governance plan reserves this decision to the sponsor.

Ask about delegation: Is there an explicit delegation covering this change?

Full phrase bank, page 40

Find a phrase by purpose / continued

Change Requests and Scope Creep

Acknowledge the value: I understand why the new report would be useful at launch.

State the current limit: The plan already uses all 20 remaining person-days.

Quantify the addition: The report is estimated at four person-days including testing.

Full phrase bank, page 52

Status Reporting and Executive Updates

Lead with the exception: The access dependency threatens the planned launch sequence.

State the rating basis: Our rules require amber for a material threat needing management attention.

Keep progress visible: Eight of ten listed tasks are complete.

Full phrase bank, page 62

Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery

Acknowledge the claim: I understand that your team considers development complete.

State the evidence position: We can verify four of the six agreed criteria.

Name the gaps: Evidence for C5 and C6 is missing from the handover package.

Full phrase bank, page 76

Post-Implementation Review

Replace the vague label: Three of five handoffs lacked recorded acknowledgment before work began.

State the linked observation: Two tasks were reworked using an older specification.

Limit the causal claim: The record does not establish one exclusive cause.

Full phrase bank, page 86

Vocabulary index

acceptance authority
Lesson 07, p. 74

acceptance criterion
Lesson 01, p. 6

acceptance evidence
Lesson 07, p. 74

acceptance plan
Lesson 07, p. 74

acceptance record
Lesson 07, p. 75

accountability
Lesson 04, p. 39

action log
Lesson 04, p. 39

action owner
Lesson 03, p. 28

actionable lesson
Lesson 08, p. 84

activity duration
Lesson 02, p. 15

actual cost
Lesson 06, p. 61

actual result
Lesson 07, p. 74

adoption check
Lesson 08, p. 85

after-action review
Lesson 08, p. 84

amber status
Lesson 06, p. 60

approval record
Lesson 05, p. 51

approval threshold
Lesson 04, p. 38

assumption
Lesson 01, p. 6

assurance review
Lesson 04, p. 39

authorization
Lesson 04, p. 38

baseline revision
Lesson 05, p. 51

baseline value
Lesson 08, p. 85

benefit
Lesson 01, p. 5

benefit impact
Lesson 05, p. 51

blameless review
Lesson 08, p. 84

business case
Lesson 01, p. 5

business need
Lesson 01, p. 5

capacity limit
Lesson 05, p. 50

causal claim
Lesson 08, p. 84

change authority
Lesson 04, p. 38

change control
Lesson 05, p. 50

change freeze
Lesson 05, p. 51

change log
Lesson 05, p. 50

change request
Lesson 05, p. 50

closure criterion
Lesson 08, p. 85

closure evidence
Lesson 03, p. 29

commercial consequence
Lesson 07, p. 75

comparison window
Lesson 08, p. 85

completion claim
Lesson 07, p. 75

conditional acceptance
Lesson 07, p. 75

conditional approval
Lesson 04, p. 39

confidence qualifier
Lesson 06, p. 61

consensus
Lesson 04, p. 39

constraint
Lesson 01, p. 6

Vocabulary index / continued

contingency plan
Lesson 03, p. 29

contingency reserve
Lesson 03, p. 29

contract owner
Lesson 07, p. 75

contributing factor
Lesson 08, p. 84

corrective action
Lesson 08, p. 84

cost performance index
Lesson 06, p. 61, Case 1, p. 96

cost variance
Case 1, p. 96

crashing
Lesson 02, p. 16

critical path
Lesson 02, p. 15

Daily Scrum
Case 2, p. 101

decision deadline
Lesson 03, p. 29

decision latency
Lesson 05, p. 51

decision log
Lesson 04, p. 39

decision paper
Lesson 04, p. 39

decision rights
Lesson 04, p. 38

decision use
Lesson 01, p. 6

defect
Lesson 07, p. 75

defect ownership
Case 3, p. 106

deferred feature
Lesson 05, p. 50

Definition of Done
Case 2, p. 101

delegated authority
Lesson 04, p. 38

deliverable
Lesson 01, p. 5

deliverable register
Lesson 07, p. 74

delivery confidence
Lesson 06, p. 60

dependency due date
Lesson 06, p. 60

dependency owner
Lesson 06, p. 60

dissent
Lesson 04, p. 39

downstream impact
Lesson 02, p. 16

due date
Lesson 08, p. 85

earned value
Lesson 06, p. 61, Case 1, p. 96

effectiveness review
Lesson 08, p. 85

effort estimate
Lesson 05, p. 50

elapsed duration
Lesson 05, p. 50

end user
Lesson 01, p. 6

endorsement
Lesson 04, p. 38

escalation brief
Lesson 03, p. 29

escalation matrix
Case 3, p. 106

escalation route
Lesson 04, p. 39

escalation threshold
Lesson 03, p. 29

estimate at completion
Case 1, p. 96

evidence gap
Lesson 07, p. 74

evidence handoff
Lesson 07, p. 75

exception report
Lesson 06, p. 61

executive ask
Lesson 06, p. 61

Vocabulary index / continued

expected result
Lesson 07, p. 74

fallback plan
Lesson 03, p. 29

fast-tracking
Lesson 02, p. 16

finish-to-start dependency
Lesson 02, p. 15

forecast variance
Lesson 02, p. 16

formal acceptance
Lesson 07, p. 75

free float
Lesson 02, p. 16

governance
Lesson 04, p. 38

green status
Lesson 06, p. 60

handover package
Lesson 07, p. 75

hypercare
Case 3, p. 106

impact
Lesson 03, p. 28

impact assessment
Lesson 05, p. 50

implementation instruction
Lesson 05, p. 51

improvement backlog
Lesson 08, p. 84

in scope
Lesson 01, p. 5

Increment
Case 2, p. 101

incremental cost
Lesson 05, p. 51

issue
Lesson 03, p. 28

issue log
Lesson 03, p. 28

key milestone
Lesson 06, p. 60

knowledge transfer
Lesson 08, p. 84

lag
Lesson 02, p. 15

lagging indicator
Lesson 06, p. 61

lead
Lesson 02, p. 15

leading indicator
Lesson 06, p. 60

lessons log
Lesson 08, p. 84

likelihood
Lesson 03, p. 28

milestone
Lesson 02, p. 16

minutes
Lesson 04, p. 39

mitigation
Lesson 03, p. 29

nonconformance
Lesson 07, p. 75

operational acceptance
Case 3, p. 106

opportunity
Lesson 03, p. 28

opportunity cost
Lesson 05, p. 51

option comparison
Lesson 05, p. 51

out of scope
Lesson 01, p. 5

outcome
Lesson 01, p. 5

outcome measure
Lesson 08, p. 85

percent complete
Lesson 06, p. 61

person-day
Lesson 05, p. 50

planned value
Lesson 06, p. 61, Case 1, p. 96

post-implementation review
Lesson 08, p. 84

predecessor
Lesson 02, p. 15

Vocabulary index / continued

preventive action
Lesson 08, p. 84

process measure
Lesson 08, p. 85

process owner
Lesson 08, p. 85

Product Backlog
Case 2, p. 101

project charter
Lesson 01, p. 5

project objective
Lesson 01, p. 5

project sponsor
Lesson 01, p. 5

punch list
Lesson 07, p. 75

quorum
Lesson 04, p. 38

RACI
Lesson 04, p. 39

RAG rating
Lesson 06, p. 60

recipient acknowledgment
Lesson 08, p. 85

recommendation
Lesson 04, p. 38

recovery option
Lesson 02, p. 16

red status
Lesson 06, p. 60

release boundary
Lesson 05, p. 51

remaining duration
Lesson 02, p. 15

remit
Lesson 04, p. 38

reporting period
Lesson 06, p. 60

requirement
Lesson 01, p. 6

requirements matrix
Lesson 07, p. 74

requirements traceability
Lesson 01, p. 6

resequence
Lesson 02, p. 16

residual risk
Lesson 03, p. 29

resource leveling
Lesson 02, p. 16

response status
Lesson 03, p. 29

rework
Lesson 05, p. 51

risk
Lesson 03, p. 28

risk exposure
Lesson 03, p. 28

risk owner
Lesson 03, p. 28

risk register
Lesson 03, p. 28

risk response
Lesson 03, p. 29

root-cause hypothesis
Lesson 08, p. 84

runbook
Case 3, p. 106

sample size
Lesson 08, p. 85

schedule baseline
Lesson 02, p. 15

schedule compression
Lesson 02, p. 16

schedule forecast
Lesson 02, p. 15

schedule performance index
Lesson 06, p. 61

schedule variance
Case 1, p. 96

scope approval
Lesson 01, p. 6

scope baseline
Lesson 01, p. 5

scope creep
Lesson 05, p. 50

scope statement
Lesson 01, p. 5

Vocabulary index / continued

scope substitution
Lesson 05, p. 50

slippage
Lesson 02, p. 16

Sprint Goal
Case 2, p. 101

stakeholder
Lesson 01, p. 6

status date
Lesson 06, p. 60

steering group
Lesson 04, p. 38

successor
Lesson 02, p. 15

task-count completion
Lesson 06, p. 61

test coverage
Lesson 05, p. 51

test environment
Lesson 07, p. 74

threat
Lesson 03, p. 28

trade-off
Lesson 05, p. 50

version reference
Lesson 08, p. 85

weighted progress
Lesson 06, p. 61

work package
Lesson 01, p. 6

working day
Lesson 02, p. 15

secondary risk
Lesson 03, p. 29

Sprint Backlog
Case 2, p. 101

stage gate
Lesson 04, p. 39

statement of work
Lesson 07, p. 74

status report
Lesson 06, p. 60

success measure
Lesson 01, p. 6

support model
Case 3, p. 106

terms of reference
Lesson 04, p. 38

test data
Lesson 07, p. 74

test result
Lesson 07, p. 74

total float
Lesson 02, p. 16

trigger
Lesson 03, p. 28

waiver
Lesson 07, p. 75

work breakdown structure
Lesson 01, p. 6

working calendar
Lesson 02, p. 15

References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.

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Background on recording, assessing, and deciding proposed baseline changes. The trade-off cases and decisions in this book are original. Source checked 10 October 2026.

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https://www.nasa.gov/reference/appendix-d-requirements-verification-matrix/

Companion course

The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.

https://englishladder.com/efsp-project-management.html

Make the dependency visible. Make the decision clear.

Eight delivery conversations that turn requests, dates, risks, and progress claims into precise project communication.

Project Charter and Scope Definition

A dashboard is an output; improved queue decisions would be an intended outcome. The proposed users and exclusions narrow the request, but they do not confirm access, acceptance, or schedule feasibility. Four weeks remains a target until supported and authorized.

Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies

Baseline: testing through day 5, rehearsal days 6-7, approval day 8. Forecast: testing through day 8, rehearsal days 9-10, approval day 11. The milestone moves three working days, not three days for each downstream task.

Risk Register and Issue Escalation

The missed commitment is a present issue once confirmed; the replacement date and final effect may still be uncertain. Update the issue and linked risk records without erasing the history or pretending every downstream consequence is already known.

Stakeholder Alignment and Governance

Consensus in the steering group does not override the sponsor authority stated in this case. A quorum only answers whether the group can validly conduct its own business; it does not enlarge its remit or create an unrecorded delegation.

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